METRIC

MIL–PRF–31032/4C
w/AMENDMENT 2
14 July 2018
SUPERSEDING
MIL–PRF–31032/4C
w/AMENDMENT 1
8 January 2018

The documentation and process conversion measures necessary to comply with this revision shall be completed by:
14 November 2018.

PERFORMANCE SPECIFICATION SHEET

PRINTED WIRING BOARD, RIGID FLEX OR FLEXIBLE, MULTILAYER, WITH PLATED–THROUGH HOLES, WITH OR WITHOUT STIFFENERS, FOR SOLDERED PART MOUNTING

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense

The requirements for acquiring the product described herein shall consist of this specification sheet and MIL–PRF–31032.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the generic performance requirements for multilayered (three or more conductor layers) rigid-flex or flexible (with or without stiffeners) printed wiring boards (hereafter designated printed board) with plated holes that will use soldering for component/part mounting (see 6.1.1).

1.2 Classification. Printed boards covered by this specification sheet are classified by the following types and installation uses.

1.2.1 Types. The printed board types are classified as follows, as specified (see 6.2).

Type 3 – Multilayer flexible printed board.

Type 4 – Multilayer rigid-flex printed board.

1.2.2 Installation uses. The following installation uses describe the possible usage/application of the printed boards (see 6.2.1.e).

Use A – The printed board is capable of withstanding flexing during installation (flex-to-install) (see 6.2.2.d).

Use B – Portions of the printed board are capable of withstanding continuous flexing (dynamic flex) for a number of cycles specified in the printed board procurement documentation (see 6.2.2.c).

Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be addressed to DLA Land and Maritime, ATTN: VAC, P.O. Box 3990, Columbus, OH 43218–3990, or emailed to 5998.Documents@dla.mil. Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

AMSC N/A

FSC 5998

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

1.2.3 Wrap copper plating grade. The wrap copper plating grade designation is defined by the amount of plated-through hole surface and knee continuous copper plating thickness remaining after surface processing. The grades are as follows:

A – Printed boards of this grade have 80 percent or more of the specified plated-through hole wrap copper plating thickness on the surface and knee after surface processing.

B – Printed boards of this grade have 50 percent or more of the specified plated-through hole wrap copper plating thickness on the surface and knee after surface processing.

C – Printed boards of this grade have 20 percent or more of the specified plated-through hole wrap copper plating thickness on the surface and knee after surface processing.

Unless otherwise specified, the default grade of wrap copper plating is grade A for printed board designs that will not undergo planarization and grade B for designs that require planarization.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3 and 4 of this specification. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements of documents cited in sections 3 and 4 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

2.2 Government documents. The following specification forms a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE SPECIFICATIONS

MIL–PRF–31032 – Printed Circuit Board/Printed Wiring Board, General Specification for.

(Copies of these documents are available online at http://quicksearch.dla.mil.)

2.3 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

ASTM INTERNATIONAL (ASTM)

ASTM B567 – Standard Test Method for Measurement of Coating Thickness by the Beta Backscatter Method.
ASTM B568 – Standard Test Method for Measurement of Coating Thickness by X-Ray Spectrometry.

(Copies of these documents are available online at http://www.astm.org.)

IPC – ASSOCIATION CONNECTING ELECTRONICS INDUSTRIES (IPC)

IPC–2221 – Generic Standard on Printed Board Design.
IPC–2223 – Sectional Design Standard for Flexible Printed Boards.
IPC–A–600 – Acceptability of Printed Boards.
IPC–TM–650 – Test Methods Manual.
IPC–9252 – Requirements for Electrical Testing of Unpopulated Printed Boards.

(Copies of these documents are available online at http://www.ipc.org.)

(Non–Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.4 Order of precedence. Unless otherwise noted herein or in contract, in the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Printed board detail requirements. Printed boards delivered under this specification shall be in accordance with the requirements as specified herein, and documented in the printed board procurement documentation.

3.1.1 Conflicting requirements. The order of precedence of conflicting requirements shall be in accordance with MIL–PRF–31032.

3.1.2 Reference to printed board procurement documentation. For the purposes of this specification, when the term "specified" is used without additional reference to a specific location or document, the intended reference shall be to the applicable printed board procurement documentation.

3.1.3 Terms and definitions. The definitions for all terms used herein shall be as specified in MIL–PRF–31032.

3.2 Qualification. Printed boards furnished under this specification shall be technologies that are manufactured by a manufacturer authorized by the qualifying activity for listing on the applicable qualified manufacturers list before contract award (see 4.2 and 6.3).

3.3 Design (see 3.1 and 6.2). Printed boards shall be of the design specified. Unless otherwise noted herein, if individual design parameters are not specified in the printed board procurement documentation, then the baseline design parameters shall be as specified as follows:

a. Overall printed board design baseline shall be in accordance with IPC–2223, type 3 or type 4, performance class 3.

b. Test coupons design, quantity, placement, and usage shall be in accordance with IPC–2221, performance class 3. Test coupons shall be as specified in the applicable design standard and shall reflect worst-case design conditions of the printed boards that they represent. Test coupon selection and usage shall be determined by the manufacturer in order to meet the in-process, LCI, PCI and CVI inspection requirements herein.

3.4 Printed board materials. All materials used in the construction of compliant printed boards shall comply with the applicable specifications referenced in the printed board procurement documentation. If materials used in the production of printed boards are not specified, then it is the manufacturer's responsibility to use materials which will meet the performance requirements of this specification sheet. Acceptance or approval of any printed board material shall not be construed as a guarantee of the acceptance of the completed printed board.

3.4.1 Prohibited materials (see 6.8). Unless otherwise specified, electroplated or immersion tin shall not be used as a finish either externally, internally, or as an undercoat. Electroplated or immersion tin is any tin or tin alloy containing more than 97 percent tin. If used as a finish, tin shall be alloyed with a minimum of three percent lead. The use of tin–lead (Sn–Pb) finish is acceptable provided that the minimum lead content is three percent.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5 External visual and dimensional requirements. Printed board test specimens (the finished printed boards or supporting test coupons, as applicable) shall conform to the requirements specified in 3.5.1 through 3.5.7.2, as applicable. Scratches, dents, and tool marks shall not bridge or expose signal conductors, expose base metal, expose or disrupt reinforcement fibers, reduce dielectric properties, or reduce spacing below the minimum requirements herein. The figures, illustrations, and photographs contained in IPC–A–600 can aid in the visualization of externally observable accept/reject conditions of printed wiring boards or test specimens.

3.5.1 Base material.

3.5.1.1 Edges of base material. Base material edges include the external edge of the printed board, the edges of cutouts, and the edges of non–plated–through holes.

3.5.1.1.1 Edges of flexible base material. The trimmed edge of completed printed boards shall be free of defects such as burrs, delaminations, nicks, or tears in excess of those allowed in 3.5.1.1.2 and 3.5.1.2. Following the solderability or resistance to soldering heat test, discolorations or resin recession at completed or trimmed edges of the flexible base material shall be acceptable provided that the discoloration or resin recession defect does not reduce the edge spacing below the specified requirements.

3.5.1.1.2 Edges of rigid base material. Defects such as burrs, chips, delaminations, haloing, nicks, and other penetrations along the rigid base material edges of completed printed boards shall be acceptable provided the defect does not reduce the edge spacing specified by more than 50 percent or 2.5 mm (.098 inch), whichever is smaller. If no edge spacing requirement is specified, any base material edge defect shall not exceed 2.5 mm (.0984 inch). Base material edges include the external edge of the printed board, the edges of cutouts, and the edges of non–plated-through holes. Loose metallic burrs shall not be acceptable.

3.5.1.2 Surface imperfections.

3.5.1.2.1 Assorted imperfections. Imperfections in the surface of the base material such as blistering, burrs, cuts, dents, exposed reinforcement material fibers, foreign materials, gouges, nicks, pits, resin scorched areas, resin starved areas, scratches, tool marks, variations in color such as white spots or black spots, or other visual defects detrimental to the performance of the base material shall be acceptable in localized concentrations providing the following conditions are met:

a. The imperfections do not bridge between conductors.

b. The dielectric spacing between the imperfection and a conductor is not reduced below the specified minimum conductor spacing requirements.

3.5.1.2.2 Exposed or disrupted fibers. Exposed or disrupted reinforcement fibers on the horizontal surface of the printed board shall not bridge conductors and shall not reduce the conductor spacing below the minimum conductor spacing requirements. Unless otherwise specified, weave texture (reinforcement texture) or exposed reinforcement material fibers caused by mechanical fabrication operations shall be acceptable provided they meet the exposed or disrupted reinforcement fiber requirements.

3.5.1.2.3 Surface pits and voids. Surface pits and voids in the base material shall be acceptable providing the following conditions are met:

a. Surface pits or voids are no bigger than 0.8 mm (.031 inch) in the longest dimension.

b. The surface pits or voids do not bridge conductors.

c. The total area of all surface pits or voids does not exceed five percent of the total printed board area.

d. The surface pit or void does not affect the performance of the base material.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5.1.3 Subsurface imperfections. Subsurface imperfections (such as adhesive voids, blistering, delamination, foreign inclusions, and haloing) shall be acceptable providing the following conditions are met:

a. The imperfection is translucent.

b. The imperfections do not bridge more than 25 percent of the distance between access holes, conductors, or plated-through holes and vias. No more than two percent of the printed board area on each side shall be affected.

c. The imperfections do not reduce conductor or dielectric spacing below the specified minimum requirements (see 3.1 and 3.3).

d. The imperfections do not propagate as a result of testing (such as rework simulation, resistance to soldering heat, or thermal shock).

e. The longest dimension of any single imperfection is no greater than 0.80 mm (.031 inch). In non-circuitry areas, the maximum size shall not be greater than 2.00 mm (.079 inch) in the longest dimension or 0.01 percent of the printed board area, maximum.

f. Following the solderability or the resistance to soldering heat test, discoloration or resin recession shall be acceptable at access hole edges provided that they do not reduce the edge spacing below the specified requirements.

NOTE: Color variations or mottled appearance in bond enhancement treatments shall be acceptable.

3.5.1.4 Measling and crazing. Unless otherwise specified, measling and crazing shall comply with the class 3 acceptable conditions of IPC–A–600.

3.5.2 Conductor pattern.

3.5.2.1 Bonding of conductor to base material and lifted lands. There shall be no peeling or lifting of any conductor pattern or land from the base material. The completed printed board shall not exhibit any lifted land. (NOTE: See 3.6.2.5 for allowances for the acceptable lifting of lands, i.e. lifted lands, following rework simulation, resistance to soldering heat, and thermal shock testing.)

3.5.2.2 Conductor finish (plating or coating). The conductor finish shall be as specified. A conductor finish plating or coating material shall be used that enables the printed wiring board to meet all of the performance requirements of this specification. Unless otherwise specified, the following conductor finish conditions shall apply.

3.5.2.2.1 Coverage. The conductor finish shall cover the exposed horizontal portion of the conductor pattern as specified herein. Voids in the conductor finish coverage of plated-through hole walls shall comply with the requirements herein (see 3.5.2.2.2).

3.5.2.2.1.1 Metallic coatings or platings (not containing Sn or Pb). The conductor finish plating or coating shall cover the basis metal of the conductive pattern. There shall be no evidence of any flaking, lifting, or separation of conductor finish coating or plating from the surface of the conductive pattern.

3.5.2.2.1.2 Tin alloys, reflowed tin-lead, or solder coated surfaces. The conductor finish shall cover the exposed horizontal portion of the conductor pattern. Coverage of a conductor by solder does not apply to the vertical conductor edges. The following conditions shall apply:

a. A maximum of five percent of dewetting is permitted on any conductive surface where a solder connection will be required. Dewetting on conductors, ground, or voltage planes not used for solder connections shall meet the requirements of appendix J of MIL–PRF–31032.

b. Nonwetting is not permitted on any conductive surface where a solder connection will be required. Absence of solder on the vertical sides of lands shall be acceptable.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5.2.2.2 Conductor finish plating and coating voids in plated-through holes. The conductor finish plating and coating shall not have voids that exceed the following limits:

a. No more than one final finish void in any plated-through hole.

b. Not more than five percent of the plated-through holes shall have final finish voids.

c. Any final finish void present is not more than five percent of the plated-through hole length.

d. Any final finish void present is less than 90 degrees of the circumference of the plated-through hole.

3.5.2.2.3 Plating junctions. Unless otherwise specified, the following requirements apply to all junctions of different plating or coating materials:

a. There shall be no exposed copper in the junction of metallic platings or coatings.

b. An overlap of metallic platings or coatings shall be acceptable if it is no greater than 0.8 mm (.031 inch) in length.

c. When both solder coating and gold plating are present at a plating junction, a discolored or gray–black area at that plating overlap zone shall be acceptable.

3.5.2.2.4 Thickness (non-destructive). The plating or coating thickness of the conductor finish shall be as specified. For designs requiring reflowed tin-lead plating or solder coating as a final conductor finish coverage, no thickness measurement is required. For designs requiring unfused tin-lead plating as a final conductor finish coverage, the thickness shall be as specified.

3.5.2.2.5 Whiskers. There shall be no whiskers of solder or other platings on the surface of the conductor pattern.

3.5.2.3 Conductor pattern imperfections. The conductor pattern shall contain no cracks, splits, or tears. Imperfections in conductor patterns shall be acceptable provided they do not exceed the defect requirements specified herein.

3.5.2.3.1 Assorted imperfections. Unless otherwise specified, any combination of edge roughness, nicks, pinholes, cuts, or scratches exposing the base material shall not reduce each conductor width by more than 20 percent of its minimum specified width. There shall be no occurrence of the 20 percent width reductions greater than 13.0 mm (.51 inch) or 10 percent of a conductor length, whichever is less.

3.5.2.3.2 Cuts and scratches. A cut or scratch of any length or width is permissible on ground or voltage planes, provided the dielectric is not exposed. Cut or scratches on non–critical conductors may be of any length, but no deeper than 20 percent of the total conductor thickness.

3.5.2.3.3 Dents. A dent of any length or width on ground planes shall be acceptable provided the clad surface is not torn. Dents on conductive patterns may be of any length, but no deeper than 0.013 mm (.0005 inch).

3.5.2.3.4 Pinholes. Pinholes in ground or voltage planes in non–critical areas shall be acceptable provided they have no single diameter greater than 0.5 mm (.0197 inch) and do not exceed three for each 25 mm (.984 inch) diameter. A pinhole in a conductive pattern shall be acceptable, provided it does not reduce the width of a conductive pattern by 10 percent. Pinholes shall be limited to no more than one for each 25 mm (.984 inch) of conductive length.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5.2.3.5 Pits. Pits in ground or voltage planes shall be acceptable provided they do not exceed 25 percent of the surface area. Any pit in the conductive pattern is acceptable provided the outline dimension does not exceed ten percent of the conductor width, and there is no more than one pit for each 25 mm (.984 inch) of the conductor length.

3.5.2.3.6 Superfluous metal. Unless otherwise specified, small particles of metal, such as residual copper or subsequent plating after etching, which remain affixed to areas that are intended to be free of conductive material, shall be acceptable providing the following conditions are met:

a. The superfluous metal are no closer than 6.4 mm (.25 inch) to any conductor.

b. The superfluous metal are smaller than 0.13 mm (.005 inch) at their greatest diameter.

3.5.2.4 Conductor width and spacing.

3.5.2.4.1 Conductor spacing. Conductor spacing, including tolerance, shall be as specified.

3.5.2.4.2 Conductor width. Conductor width shall be as specified. Unless otherwise specified, allowable reduction in the conductor width due to isolated defects or misregistration shall be in accordance with 3.5.2.3.

3.5.2.4.3 Edge spacing. The minimum edge spacing shall be as specified.

3.5.2.5 Lands for component mounting. The lands to be used for component mounting shall be as specified. Imperfections on component hole lands, surface mount lands, or wire bond pads shall be acceptable provided they do not exceed the defect allowance requirements specified herein.

3.5.2.5.1 Component hole lands. Unless otherwise specified, the external annular ring may have in isolated areas a 20 percent reduction of the specified minimum external annular ring due to defects such coverlayer (see 3.5.3.1) or stiffener (see 3.5.6.2) access hole misregistration, dents, pinholes, pits, or nicks. No more than 20 percent of the annular ring circumference (72 degrees) may be affected.

3.5.2.5.1.1 Adhesive on lands of solderable plated-through holes. Unless otherwise specified, the minimum external annular ring for solderable plated-through holes shall not be reduced by more than 10 percent due to adhesives extruded onto lands.

3.5.2.5.1.2 Adhesive on lands of unsupported holes. Unless otherwise specified, the minimum external annular ring for solderable unsupported holes shall not be reduced by more than 20 percent due to adhesives extruded onto lands.

3.5.2.5.2 Rectangular surface mount lands (see figure 1). The size of the rectangular surface mount land shall be as specified. The pristine area of the land is defined as the area within the 80 percent of the land width by 80 percent of the land length as shown on figure 1. Unless otherwise specified, defects such as nicks, dents, and pin holes along the external edge of the land shall not exceed 20 percent of either the length or width of the land and shall not encroach the pristine area. Defects internal to the land shall not exceed 10 percent of the length or width of the land and shall remain outside of the pristine area of the surface mount land. One electrical test probe 'witness' mark shall be acceptable within the pristine area.

3.5.2.5.3 Round surface mount lands (ball grid array [BGA] lands) (see figure 2). The size of the round surface mount land shall be as specified. Unless otherwise specified, defects such as nicks, dents, and pin holes along the edge of the land shall not radially extend towards the center of the land by more than 10 percent of the diameter of the land and shall not extend more than 20 percent around the circumference of the land as shown on figure 2. There shall be no defects within the pristine area which is defined by the central 80 percent of the land diameter. One electrical test probe 'witness' mark shall be acceptable within the pristine area.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5.2.5.4 Wire bond lands. Unless otherwise specified, the maximum conductor finish roughness (surface roughness) for pads or areas designated for wire bonding shall be no greater than 0.8 micrometers (31 micro inches). Unless otherwise specified, the wire bond land bonding area shall be defined as the pristine area as shown on figure 1 for rectangular pads or on figure 2 for round pads. There shall be no pits, nodules, scratches, electrical test probe witness marks, or other defects in the pristine area that exceed the surface roughness limits.

3.5.2.6 Holes for layer-to-layer connections. The external annular ring of holes used for layer-to-layer connections shall be as specified. Unless otherwise specified, the external annular ring may have in isolated areas a 20 percent reduction of the specified minimum external annular ring due to defects such as dents, pinholes, pits, or nicks.

3.5.2.7 Registration, external. The registration of lands used for component mounting shall be as specified.

3.5.3 Coverlayer.

3.5.3.1 Access hole registration. The coverlayer registration shall be such that the size or diameter of the access hole shall not reduce the component land area or minimum annular ring below the limits specified (see 3.5.2.5.1). Misregistration of the coverlayer shall not expose adjacent isolated conductors or lands.

3.5.3.2 Delamination. There shall be no coverlayer delamination along the outer edges of the coverlayer. Coverlayer delamination shall be acceptable providing the following conditions are met:

a. At random locations away from conductors if each delamination is no larger than 6.45 square mm (.010 square inch), and is not within 1.0 mm (.040 inch) of the printed board edge or an access hole edge. The total number of the above delaminations shall not exceed three in any 645 square mm (1.0 square inch) of coverlayer surface area.

b. Along conductor edges, the total delamination does not exceed either 0.051 mm (.02 inch) in width or 20 percent of the spacing between adjacent conductors, whichever is smaller.

3.5.3.2.1 Delamination after flexibility endurance or folding flexibility testing. After exposure to the flexibility endurance test (see 3.7.4.5 and 4.7.4.5) or folding flexibility test (see 3.7.4.6 and 4.7.4.6), there shall be no propagation of any coverlayer delamination in the flex area.

3.5.3.3 Solder wicking. Wicking of solder under the coverlayer shall be acceptable provided the conductor spacing requirements are met.

3.5.3.4 Wrinkles or creases. Wrinkles or creases in the coverlayer shall be acceptable provided the requirements of 3.5.3.2 are met.

3.5.4 Dimensional (interface and physical dimension) requirements. The completed printed board shall meet the interface and physical dimensions requirements specified. The dimensional requirements include items such as the conductor pattern including component lands and terminals, cutouts, overall board thickness, periphery, and other design features as specified. In the event that a dimensional characteristic is not specified, the applicable class 3 of IPC–2221 or IPC–2223 design default for that characteristic shall apply.

3.5.4.1 Conductor pattern feature accuracy. Conductor pattern feature accuracy shall be as specified.

3.5.4.2 Edge board contacts edge condition. The end or beveled edge of edge board contacts shall be smooth with no burrs, roughness, or lifted plating. There shall be no separation of the edge board contacts from the base material or any loose reinforcement fibers on the beveled edge. Exposed copper on the end or beveled edge of the edge board contact shall be acceptable. Conductor finish plating or coating shall comply with the requirements of 3.5.2.2.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5.4.3 Hole pattern accuracy. The location of the hole pattern in the printed board shall be as specified.

3.5.4.4 Hole size. The hole size and tolerance shall be as specified. Unless otherwise specified, hole size tolerance shall be applied after plating. Nodules or rough plating in plated-through holes shall not reduce the hole diameter below the minimum limits specified.

3.5.4.5 Copper–defined BGA lands. BGA lands using copper–defined lands shall comply with the class 3 acceptable conditions of IPC–A–600.

3.5.5 Solder mask (when applicable). The cured solder mask shall not exhibit any chalking, crazing, peeling, skipping (skip coverage), softening, swelling, or wrinkles in excess of the limits specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the solder mask conditions below shall apply.

3.5.5.1 Coverage. Solder mask coverage imperfections (such as blisters, delaminations, pits, skips, wrinkles, and voids) shall be acceptable providing the following conditions are met:

a. The solder mask imperfection shall not expose two adjacent conductors whose spacing is less than the electrical spacing required for the voltage range and environmental condition specified in the applicable design standard.

b. In areas containing parallel conductors, the solder mask imperfection shall not expose two isolated conductors whose spacing is less than 0.5 mm (.02 inch) unless one of the conductors is a test point or other feature area which is purposely left uncoated for subsequent operations.

c. Unless otherwise specified, the exposed conductor shall not be bare copper. For designs using solder mask over bare copper, if an allowance for bare copper is specified, it shall be acceptable to have a maximum of 0.25 mm (.010 inch) of exposed bare copper at the interface between the solder mask and the conductor finish.

d. The solder mask imperfection does not expose tented via holes.

e. Blister, pits or voids in non-conductor areas shall be acceptable if they have adherent edges and do not exhibit blistering or lifting in excess of that allowed in 3.7.4.3.

3.5.5.2 Discoloration. Discoloration of metallic surfaces under the cured solder mask is acceptable.

3.5.5.3 Registration. The solder mask shall be registered to the land or terminal patterns in such a manner as to meet the requirements specified. If no requirements are specified, the following apply:

a. Unless otherwise specified, solder mask shall not encroach onto surface mount lands.

b. Solder mask misregistration onto plated-through component hole lands (plated-through holes to which solder connections are to be made) shall not reduce the external annular ring below the specified minimum requirements.

c. Solder mask shall not encroach into plated-through hole barrels or onto other surface features (such as connector fingers or lands of unsupported holes) to which solder connections will be made.

d. Solder mask is permitted in plated-through holes or vias in which no lead is to be soldered.

e. Test points which are intended for assembly testing shall be free of solder mask unless a partial coverage allowance is specified.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5.5.4 Thickness. Solder mask thickness shall be as specified.

3.5.5.5 Solder mask cure. The cured solder mask coating shall not exhibit tackiness, blistering, or delamination in excess of that allowed in 3.5.5.1.

3.5.5.6 Soda straw voids. There shall be no visible soda straw voids between the solder mask and the printed board base material surface and the edges of the conductor patterns.

3.5.5.7 Solder mask–defined BGA lands. BGA lands using solder mask–defined lands or solder dam designs shall comply with the class 3 acceptable conditions of IPC–A–600.

3.5.6 Stiffeners (see 6.7).

3.5.6.1 Acceptability, design, and placement. The design, placement, and acceptability requirements for stiffeners shall be as specified.

3.5.6.2 Stiffener access hole registration. Stiffener access hole registration shall be such that the size or diameter of the access hole shall not reduce the component land area or minimum annular ring below the limits specified (see 3.5.2.5).

3.5.7 Via protection. Applicable to external layers only.

3.5.7.1 Cap plating (see figure 3). When the design requires the copper cap plating of filled vias (see 3.1), all vias required to be protected by cap plating shall be completely covered by the cap plating. The plated copper surface shall be planar with no indication of the filled via underneath. Visually discernable protrusions (bumps) and depressions (dimples) in the copper plating over filled vias shall be acceptable providing they meet the requirements of 3.6.5. Voids in the copper cap plating over the filled portion of the via shall not be acceptable.

3.5.7.2 Solder mask plugging. When the design requires that through vias be plugged by solder mask, the percentage of plugging shall be as specified. Voids in the solder mask within the plugged hole shall be as specified.

3.5.7.3 Solder mask tenting (see figure 4). When the design requires the tenting of solder mask over unfilled vias, all vias required to be protected shall be completely covered by solder mask. Voids in the solder mask over the via exposing the hole shall not be acceptable.

3.6 Plated hole structural requirements (see figures 5 through 6). When plated hole structures are examined in cross-section, the microsectioned test specimen shall meet the requirements of 3.6.1 through 3.6.5.2, as applicable. Plated hole structures includes plated-through holes, blind vias, buried vias, low aspect ratio blind vias, microvias and the base material that surrounds them. If not specified on the applicable printed board procurement documentation (see 3.1) or herein, the requirements of 3.3 shall be met. IPC–A–600 contains figures, illustrations, and photographs that can aid in the visualization of internally observable accept/reject conditions of microsectioned test specimens. If a condition is not addressed herein, or specified on the printed board procurement documentation, it shall comply with the class 3 criteria of IPC–A–600. The thermal zones of plated hole structures are shown on figures 5 and 6.

3.6.1 Base material. Unless otherwise specified, the following base material acceptance criteria shall apply.

3.6.1.1 Adhesive voids (when applicable). Adhesive voids in the flexible metal clad base material no greater than 0.5 mm (.02 inch) or 25 percent of conductor spacing, whichever is less, shall be acceptable. Multiple adhesive voids in the same plane between adjacent plated hole structures shall not have a combined length which exceeds 0.5 mm (.02 inch).

3.6.1.2 Delamination. Printed wiring boards shall have no delaminations.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.6.1.3 Dielectric layer thickness (layer-to-layer separation). The minimum dielectric thickness between conductor layers shall be as specified.

3.6.1.4 Laminate (base material) cracks and voids(see figure 5). Laminate cracks and voids located wholly in zone A shall be acceptable. Laminate cracks and voids between two uncommon conductors (in either the horizontal or vertical directions) shall not decrease the specified minimum dielectric spacing. Laminate cracks and voids that originate in zone A and encroach into zone B shall not exceed a length of 0.08 mm (.003 inch). Laminate cracks and voids entirely in zone B shall not exceed a length of 0.08 mm (.003 inch), shall not bridge adjacent uncommon conductors, and shall not reduce dielectric spacing, either horizontally or vertically, below the minimum specified spacing. Multiple laminate cracks and voids located between two adjacent plated hole structures shall not have a combined length that exceeds these limits. After undergoing rework simulation (see 3.7.4.7), resistance to soldering heat (see 3.7.6.2) or thermal shock (see 3.7.6.3), laminate voids are not evaluated in zone A.

3.6.1.5 Resin fill of blind and buried vias. Unless otherwise specified, the fill requirements for blind vias shall be 75 percent minimum. Unless otherwise specified, buried vias shall be at least 95 percent filled with the laminating resin or similar via filling material.

3.6.1.6 Resin recession (see figures 5 and 6).

3.6.1.6.1 Stressed specimens (after rework simulation, resistance to soldering heat, or thermal shock testing). Resin recession at the outer surface of the plated hole structure barrel shall be permitted and is not cause for rejection.

3.6.1.6.2 Non-stressed specimens. Resin recession at the outer surface of the plated hole structure barrel shall be permitted provided the maximum depth as measured from the barrel wall does not exceed 0.08 mm (.003 inch) and the resin recession on any side of the plated hole structure does not exceed 40 percent of the cumulative base material thickness (sum of the dielectric layer thickness being evaluated) on the side of the plated hole structure being evaluated.

3.6.2 Conductor pattern.

3.6.2.1 Conductor finish. Unless otherwise specified, the following conductor finish conditions specified shall apply.

3.6.2.1.1 Conductor finishes of tin alloys, reflowed tin–lead, or solder coating. For conductor finishes using tin alloys, reflowed tin–lead, or solder coated surfaces, the following conditions shall apply:

a. A maximum of five percent of dewetting is permitted on any conductive surface where a solder connection will be required. Dewetting on conductors, ground, or voltage planes not used for solder connections shall meet the requirements of appendix J of MIL–PRF–31032.

b. Nonwetting is not permitted on any conductive surface where a solder connection will be required. Absence of solder on the vertical sides of lands shall be acceptable.

3.6.2.1.2 Thickness (plating or coating). The plating or coating thickness of the conductor finish shall be as specified.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.6.2.2 Conductor thickness. The conductor thickness shall be as specified.

3.6.2.2.1 Minimum conductor thickness, metal foil with plating (conductors with copper plating). This requirement applies to the external layers of multilayer designs and on some of the internal layers of sequential laminated multilayer designs. When a minimum surface conductor thickness is specified, the conductor thickness (metal foil and copper plating) shall be equal to or greater than the specified thickness. When a conductor thickness with tolerance is specified, the conductor thickness (metal foil and copper plating) shall be within the specified tolerance for the specified thickness. If only a starting metal foil weight requirement is specified, the thickness limits for conductors with plating shall meet the class 3 requirements of the 'External Conductor Thickness After Plating' table of IPC–2221. If only final copper foil weight requirement is specified, the limits for minimum conductor thickness shall be as defined by the procuring activity.

3.6.2.2.2 Minimum conductor thickness, metal foil only (conductors without copper plating). This requirement applies to the internal layers of multilayer designs and on some of the internal layers of sequential laminated multilayer designs. When a minimum internal conductor thickness is specified, the conductor thickness (metal foil only) shall be equal to or greater than the specified thickness. When a conductor thickness with tolerance is specified, the conductor thickness (metal foil only) shall be within the specified tolerance for the specified thickness. For wrought or rolled metal foil types, if only a starting metal foil weight requirement is specified, a reduction in thickness up to 5 percent below the minimum allowable foil thickness specified by the applicable material specification shall be considered acceptable in order to accommodate a processing allowance for cleaning either by chemical or mechanical means. For deposited metal foil types, if only a starting metal foil weight requirement is specified, the limits for minimum internal layer foil thickness after processing shall be in accordance with the "Internal Layer Foil Thickness After Processing" table of IPC–2221. If only final metal foil weight requirement is specified, the limits for minimum conductor thickness shall be as defined by the procuring activity.

3.6.2.3 Conductor width. The conductor width shall be as specified. Unless otherwise specified, allowable reduction in the conductor width due to isolated defects shall be in accordance with 3.5.2.3.

3.6.2.4 Internal annular ring. The minimum internal annular ring shall be as specified.

3.6.2.5 Lifted lands (after rework simulation, resistance to soldering heat, or thermal shock) (see figure 7). For through vias and component holes, after undergoing rework simulation (see 3.7.4.7), resistance to soldering heat (see 3.7.6.2), or thermal shock (see 3.7.6.3), the maximum allowed lifted land distance from the printed board surface plane to the outer lower edge of the land shall be the thickness (height) of the terminal area or land. The completed, non-stressed printed board shall not exhibit any lifted lands. Lifted land shall not be acceptable on blind microvias.

3.6.3 Hole preparation prior to metallization.

3.6.3.1 Desmear (smear removal). The internal conductors of drilled holes shall be cleaned to be free of resin smear. When etchback is not specified, a negative etchback of 0.013 mm (.0005 inch) maximum shall be acceptable. Random tears or drill gouges which produce isolated areas where the smear removal depth limit is exceeded shall not be cause for rejection.

3.6.3.2 Etchback (when specified, see 3.1). When specified, the holes to be made conductive of printed boards shall be etched back for the lateral removal of base material (resin, reinforcement material, and other constituents) from the internal conductors prior to plating. The etchback shall be effective on at least the top or bottom surface of each internal conductor. Negative etchback is not acceptable when etchback is specified. Unless otherwise specified, the etchback shall be 0.005 mm (.0002 inch) minimum and no greater than the specified minimum internal annular ring or 0.051 mm (.002 inch), whichever is less, when measured at the internal copper contact area protrusion.

3.6.3.3 Treatments to sensitize the hole prior to copper plating. Conductive coatings applied to the hole wall shall be sufficient for subsequent hole wall copper plating processes. Conductive coatings may be either electroless copper, direct metallization copper, nonmetallic conductive coatings, or vacuum deposited copper, as applicable.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.6.4 Plated hole structure plating. Unless otherwise specified, the copper plating thickness of plated hole structures applies to the hole wall, the hole knee, and the surface land of the plated hole structure (see figure 8). Via cap plating shall not be included in the wrap copper measurement.

3.6.4.1 Conductive materials interfaces and separations. The term conductive interfaces shall be used to describe the junction between the hole wall plating or coating and the surfaces of internal and external layers of copper or metal foil. The interface between platings and coating (electroless copper, direct metallization copper, nonmetallic conductive coatings, or vacuum deposited copper, as applicable, and electrolytic copper, whether panel or pattern plated) shall also be considered a conductive interface. Acceptable separations in conductive interfaces shall be limited to the conditions listed herein.

3.6.4.1.1 Copper to copper interfaces (see figure 9). Except along the vertical edge of the external copper foil, there shall be no separations or contamination between the hole wall copper conductive interfaces. Conductive interface separations along the vertical edge of the external copper foil shall be acceptable. Anomalies resulting from this separation shall not be cause for rejection.

3.6.4.1.2 Dissimilar metal interfaces. For printed board deigns containing conductor layers with dissimilar metals (such as copper–invar–copper), contamination at the conductive interface shall not exceed 20 percent of the thickness of the dissimilar metal. Conductive interface separations along the vertical edge of non–copper metals, such as the invar portion of copper–invar–copper, shall be acceptable to 20 percent of their thickness.

3.6.4.2 Plated hole structure copper plating. Unless otherwise specified, the copper plating thickness shall be in accordance with the applicable design standard. Wrap plating shall meet the requirements of 3.6.4.2.2.

3.6.4.2.1 Thin copper plating. Unless otherwise specified, a 20 percent reduction of the specified hole wall copper plating thickness shall be acceptable if it is non-continuous (isolated; not more than 10 percent of the composite board thickness). Any hole wall copper plating less than 80 percent of the specified thickness shall be treated as a copper plating void in accordance with 3.6.4.3.1.

3.6.4.2.2 Wrap copper plating (see figures 10 and 11). Unless otherwise specified, the wrap plating (plated–through hole surface and knee continuous copper plating) thickness shall be as specified. Reduction of surface copper wrap plating by processing (sanding, etching, planarization, etc.) resulting in insufficient wrap plating thickness shall not be acceptable.

3.6.4.3 Copper plating defects.

3.6.4.3.1 Copper plating voids. The copper plating in the plated hole structure shall not exhibit any void in excess of the following:

a. There shall be no more than one plating void for each panel, regardless of length or size.

b. There shall be no plating void longer than five percent of the total printed board thickness.

c. There shall be no plating voids evident at the interface of any conductive layer and plated hole wall.

Conductor finish plating or coating material between the base material and copper plating (i.e., behind the hole wall copper plating) is evidence of a void. Any plated hole structure exhibiting this condition shall be counted as having one void for panel acceptance purposes.

3.6.4.3.2 Miscellaneous hole and plating deficiencies (see figures 12 and 13). Butt plating joints, circumferential separations and corner cracks shall not be acceptable. Nodules, plating folds, plating inclusions, or plated reinforcement material protrusions that project into the plated hole structure copper plating shall be acceptable provided that the hole diameter and the copper thickness are not reduced below their specified limits. Isolated areas of reduced copper thickness due to reinforcement material protrusions shall meet the minimum thickness requirements specified, when measured from the end of the protrusion to the edge of the hole plating.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.6.4.4 Metallic cracks. There shall be no cracks in the platings, coatings, or internal conductive foils. Cracks are permissible in the external layer (outer) copper foil provided they do not extend into the plated copper.

3.6.4.5 Wicking of copper plating (see figure 14). When measured from the edge of the drilled hole, the wicking of copper plating into the base material shall not extend past the calculated allowable wicking limit provided this limit does not reduce the conductor spacing below the minimum clearance spacing requirements specified. The maximum allowable wicking limit is calculated by adding the hole cleaning dielectric removal value (desmear or ecthback) plus the 0.08 mm (.003 inch) allowance for wicking. See 3.6.3.1 for dielectric removal value for desmear, or if applicable, 3.1 and 3.6.3.2 for the specified etchback value. The combination of wicking, hole cleaning dielectric removal value, and any non-contiguous tears or drill gouges caused by hole formation shall not exceed the calculated allowable wicking limit. Wicking of copper plating into the hole–fill insulation material shall not exceed 0.075 mm (.00295 inch) from the plated–through hole edge.

3.6.5 Via cap plating.

3.6.5.1 Thickness. For designs that specify copper plating for via protection, the minimum via cap plating thickness over filled vias shall be as specified. If not specified, the minimum via cap copper plating thickness over filled vias shall be in accordance with the minimum wrap copper plating thickness specified.

3.6.5.2 Cap plating imperfections (see figures 15 and 16). When cap plating of a filled via is specified, voids in the plating over the via fill shall not be acceptable. Separation of the via cap plating to non-conductive via fill material shall be acceptable. Separation of the via cap plating to underlying plating shall not be acceptable. Depressions (dimples) below the surface of the land shall be no greater than 0.08 mm (.003 inch). Protrusions (bumps) of the cap plating above the surface of the land shall be no greater than 0.05 mm (.002 inch).

3.7 Performance requirements. The performance requirements specified in 3.7.1 through 3.7.6.4.1 shall be verified by the test methods detailed in 4.7. Unless otherwise specified by the Technical Review Board (TRB), test optimization in accordance with MIL–PRF–31032 may be used, but the printed boards shall meet all of the performance requirements specified and herein, regardless of the verification method used.

3.7.1 External visual and dimensional acceptability (of printed boards). When examined as specified in 4.7.1, the printed boards shall conform to the acceptance requirements specified in 3.3 (design), 3.4 (material), 3.5 (external visual and dimensional), 3.8 (marking), and 3.9 (workmanship), inclusive.

3.7.2 Destructive physical analysis (DPA) by microsectioning and evaluation of printed board test specimens. When printed board test specimens (completed printed boards, supporting test coupons, or qualification test specimens) are microsectioned and examined as specified in 4.7.2, the requirements specified in 3.1, 3.3, and 3.6 shall be met. Microsections of non-stressed printed board test specimens shall be evaluated when the microsection examination of the stressed printed board test specimens suggest that a failure condition may exist in the completed boards (prior to being subjected to resistance to soldering heat testing).

3.7.3 Chemical requirements.

3.7.3.1 Ionic contamination (cleanliness). When printed board test specimens are tested in accordance with 4.7.3.1, the levels of ionic contamination shall be in accordance with the requirements of 3.7.3.1.1, 3.7.3.1.2, or 3.7.3.1.3 as applicable.

3.7.3.1.1 Prior to the application of solder mask. Unless otherwise specified, prior to the application of solder mask, the level of ionic contamination shall not exceed 1.56 micrograms/square centimeter (10.06 micrograms/square inch).

3.7.3.1.2 Completed printed boards (when specified, see 3.1 and 6.2.2.a). The levels of cleanliness for completed printed boards shall be as specified.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.7.3.1.3 Processed inner layers prior to lamination (when specified, see 3.1 and 6.2.2.a). The levels of ionic contamination for completed inner layers prior to lamination shall be as specified.

3.7.3.1.3 Completed printed boards (when specified, see 3.1 and 6.2.2.a). The levels of cleanliness for completed printed boards shall be as specified.

3.7.3.2 Copper plating characteristics.

3.7.3.2.1 Elongation. When copper plating is tested in accordance with 4.7.3.2, the elongation shall be 12 percent minimum.

3.7.3.2.2 Tensile strength. When copper plating is tested in accordance with 4.7.3.3, the tensile strength shall be 248 MPa (36,000 psi) minimum.

3.7.3.2.3 Purity of copper. When copper plating is tested in accordance with 4.7.3.4, the purity of the copper shall be as specified. When no value for copper purity is specified, it shall not be less than 99.5 percent.

3.7.4 Physical requirements.

3.7.4.1 Adhesion, marking. After marking is tested in accordance with 4.7.4.1, any specified markings which are missing in whole or in part, faded, shifted (dislodged), or smeared to the extent that it is no longer legible shall constitute failure. A slight change in the color of ink or paint markings after the test shall be acceptable.

3.7.4.2 Adhesion, plating. When tested as specified in 4.7.4.2, there shall be no part of the conductor pattern or copper plating protective finish (coating or plating) removed from the printed board test specimen except for those related to outgrowth, overhang, or slivers.

3.7.4.3 Adhesion, solder mask (when applicable). When tested as specified in 4.7.4.3, the maximum percentage of cured solder mask lifted from the surface of the base material, conductors, and lands of the coated printed board test specimen shall not exceed the following limits:

a. Bare copper or base material: Zero percent.

b. Non-melting metals (e.g., gold or nickel plating): Five percent.

c. Melting metals (e.g., tin-lead plating, solder coating, indium, bismuth, and others): Ten percent.

3.7.4.4 Bow and twist (type 4 and designs with stiffener and bow and twist limits)(see 6.2.2.b). When printed boards are tested as specified in 4.7.4.4, the maximum limit for bow and twist shall be as specified.

3.7.4.5 Flexibility endurance (use B only). When tested as specified in 4.7.4.5, the printed board test specimen shall be capable of withstanding the specified conditions of 3.7.4.5.1 or 3.7.4.5.2, as applicable, without any evidence of damage, degradation or rejectable delamination. After the test, the requirements specified in 3.7.5.1 and 3.7.5.2 shall be met.

3.7.4.5.1 Qualification and periodic testing. A single sided (type 1) printed board test specimen shall be capable of withstanding 100,000 cycles.

3.7.4.5.2 Acquiring activity specified (see 6.2.2.c). The test specimen shall be capable of withstanding the flexing for the number of flexing cycles, flexing rate, and points of application specified.

3.7.4.6 Folding flexibility. When tested as specified in 4.7.4.6, printed board test specimen shall be capable of withstanding the specified conditions of 3.7.4.6.1 or 3.7.4.6.2, as applicable, without any evidence of damage, degradation or rejectable delamination. After the test, the requirements specified in 3.5.3, 3.7.5.1, and 3.7.5.2 shall be met.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.7.4.6.1 Qualification and periodic testing. The baseline parameters for qualification and periodic testing shall be as follows:

a. Direction of bend: Both directions (sides).

b. Degree of bend: 180 degrees.

c. Point of application: Center of test specimen.

d. Number of fold cycles: 25.

3.7.4.6.2 Acquiring activity specified (see 6.2.2.d). The printed board test specimen shall be capable of withstanding the folding for the direction of bend, degree of bend, points of application, number of fold cycles, and diameter of mandrel specified.

3.7.4.7 Rework simulation. After undergoing the test specified in 4.7.4.7, the printed board test specimens shall be microsectioned and inspected in accordance with 4.7.2 and the requirements specified in 3.6 shall be met.

3.7.4.8 Solderability (see 6.2.2.e). Printed board designs that do not require soldering to attach components (as in the case where press–fit components or wire bonding are used) do not require solderability testing. Printed boards that require soldering during assembly processes require solderability testing. Printed boards using only surface mount components do not require hole solderability testing. When required by the procurement documentation, accelerated conditioning for coating durability shall be in accordance with appendix J of MIL–PRF–31032 (see 6.2.2.f).

3.7.4.8.1 Hole solderability. After undergoing the test specified in 4.7.4.8, the printed board test specimen shall conform to the requirements of appendix J of MIL–PRF–31032.

3.7.4.8.2 Surface solderability. After undergoing the test specified in 4.7.4.8, the printed board test specimen shall conform to the requirements of appendix J of MIL–PRF–31032.

3.7.4.9 Surface peel strength (for foil laminated construction only). When tested as specified in 4.7.4.9, the surface conductor shall yield an average peel strength greater than or equal to the values specified by the applicable base material specification. Unless otherwise specified, the peel strength shall correspond to "after thermal stress" condition, the foil profile, and the base material thickness over 0.50 mm (.0197 inch) values specified by the base material specification. When applicable, the foil type and starting weight, if addresses by the base material specification, shall apply. This requirement is only applicable to foil laminated printed boards that have surface conductors or surface mount lands. Printed wiring boards with no external circuitry (external terminal land or pads only) do not require peel strength testing.

3.7.5 Electrical requirements. If specified (see 3.1), the use of indirect testing by signature comparison for continuity and isolation may be used for production screening.

3.7.5.1 Continuity. When tested in accordance with 4.7.5.1 or 4.7.5.2, the resistance between the end–points of conductor patterns within a network of conductors shall be as specified. If no resistance limit is specified, there shall be no circuit whose resistance exceeds 10 ohms. For referee purposes, 0.5 ohm maximum for each 25.0 mm (.98 inch) of circuit length shall apply. Conductor patterns that consist of long runs of narrow conductors or short runs of very wide conductors may increase or decrease the resistance. The acceptability of these type of circuit patterns, of controlled impedance nets, or of embedded resistive patterns shall be as specified.

3.7.5.2 Isolation (circuit shorts). When tested as specified in 4.7.5.1 or 4.7.5.2, the insulation resistance between mutually isolated conductors shall be as specified. Unless otherwise specified, for production printed boards, the insulation resistance shall be greater than 100 megohms.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.7.6 Environmental requirements.

3.7.6.1 Moisture and insulation resistance. When tested as specified in 4.7.6.1, the printed board test specimen shall have a minimum of 500 megohms of resistance between conductors. After the test, the printed board test specimen shall not exhibit blistering, measling, or delamination in excess of that allowed in 3.5.1 and 3.5.3.

3.7.6.2 Resistance to soldering heat.

3.7.6.2.1 Solder float thermal stress. After undergoing the test specified in 4.7.6.2.1, the printed board test specimen shall be inspected in accordance with 4.7.1 and shall meet the requirements of 3.5.1.1.1 and 3.5.1.4. The test specimen shall then be inspected in accordance with 4.7.2 and shall meet the requirements of 3.1, 3.3, and 3.6.

3.7.6.2.2 Solder reflow thermal stress. After undergoing the test specified in 4.7.6.2.2, the printed board test specimen shall be inspected in accordance with 4.7.2 and shall meet the requirements of 3.1, 3.3, and 3.6.

3.7.6.3 Thermal shock. After undergoing the test specified in 4.7.6.3, the printed board test specimens shall meet the following requirements:

a. Visual inspection: When inspected as specified in 4.7.1, there shall be no evidence of plating cracks, blistering, crazing, or delamination in excess of that allowed in 3.5.

b. Resistance change: The change in resistance between the first high temperature cycle and the last high temperature cycle shall not be more than 10 percent.

c. DPA by microsectioning: The printed board test specimen shall be vertically cross sectioned and inspected in accordance with 4.7.2 and the requirements specified in 3.1, 3.3, and 3.6 shall be met.

3.7.6.4 Temperature cycling.

3.7.6.4.1 Direct current induced. After undergoing the test specified in 4.7.6.4.1, the printed board test specimens shall meet the following requirements: For capability verification inspection testing, the following conditions shall apply:

a. Number of samples: Six.

b. Test temperature: 150 degrees Celsius.

c. Resistance change: Ten percent.

d. Maximum number of cycles: 250 for each 24 hour period.

e. Data collection frequency: Ten cycles.

f. Cooling ratio: 0.66.

g. Table selection: System.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.8 Marking.

3.8.1 Product identification and traceability. Product identification and traceability marking shall be in accordance with MIL–PRF–31032.

3.8.2 Marking legibility. After any, or all tests, marking that is either etched, screened, or ink stamped shall comply with the class 3, acceptable conditions detailed in IPC–A–600.

3.9 Workmanship. Printed boards shall be processed in such a manner as to be uniform in quality and shall be free from defects that will affect life, serviceability, or appearance.

4. VERIFICATION

4.1 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. Qualification inspection (see 4.2).

b. Conformance inspection (see 4.3 and tables I and II).

c. Capability verification inspection (see 4.6).

4.1.1 Sampling and inspection. Sampling and inspection shall be in accordance with MIL–PRF–31032, and as specified herein.

4.1.2 Standard test and inspection conditions. Unless otherwise specified by the applicable test method or procedure, inspections and tests may be performed at ambient conditions.

4.2 Qualification inspection. Unless otherwise specified by the TRB approved qualification test plan, qualification inspection shall be in accordance with MIL–PRF–31032 and as specified herein.

4.2.1 Qualification test vehicles. The qualification test vehicle(s) to be subjected to qualification inspection shall be in accordance with the TRB approved qualification test plan and the applicable qualification test vehicle specification(s).

4.2.1.1 Sample. The number of qualification test vehicle(s) to be subjected to qualification inspection shall be in accordance with TRB approved qualification test plan.

4.2.2 Test routine. The qualification test vehicle(s) shall be subjected to the inspections and tests specified in table I and II in addition to thermal shock in accordance with 3.7.6.3 and 4.7.6.3.

4.2.3 Qualification by similarity. A production lot may be considered qualified by similarity if the dimensional parameters are within twenty-five percent of those currently qualified and the processing steps used are a set or subset of those processes used for a previous qualified technology. When producing printed board designs that exceed the currently qualified process limits, the TRB shall review and approve the final product.

4.3 Conformance inspection. Conformance inspection shall be in accordance with MIL–PRF–31032 and shall consist of lot conformance inspection (see 4.4) and periodic conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 Lot conformance inspection. Lot conformance inspection shall be in accordance with MIL–PRF–31032 and table I herein. Panels , pallets, and printed boards to be delivered in accordance with this specification shall have been subjected to and passed all applicable inspections and tests of table I prior to delivery of product. Lot conformance inspection testing by subgroup or within a subgroup may be performed in any sequence.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4.1 Subgroup 1 inspections (panel acceptance). The panel acceptance test shall be in accordance with MIL–PRF–31032, and as specified in table I, subgroup 1.

4.4.1.1 Sampling, design without blind and buried vias. A minimum of two test coupons (one A and one B test coupon) for each completed panel shall be subjected to the resistance to soldering heat test. The two test coupons shall be taken from opposite corners of the panel. After the test, one of the test coupons shall be microsectioned in the panel's length (X direction) and the other shall be microsectioned along the panel's width (Y direction).

4.4.1.2 Sampling, designs with blind or buried vias. In addition to the sampling required in 4.4.1.1, printed boards designs with blind and buried vias shall have, for each copper plating process used, additional resistance to soldering heat test coupons microsectioned for each panel in the lot. Unless otherwise specified, the registration of all hole designs present on the printed board shall be verified by either DPA inspection or a TRB approved non-destructive method.

4.4.1.3 Percent defective allowable (PDA) limits. The PDA limits for panel acceptance shall be 32 percent.

4.4.1.4 Failure mode observations. If the results of DPA by microsectioning and evaluation of test specimens indicate a potential failure mode in the stressed printed board test specimens (i.e., propagation of subsurface imperfections, lifted lands within post-resistance to soldering heat acceptance criteria, or other indicators), additional cross sections and microsection examination of non-stressed test specimens shall be performed.

4.4.2 Subgroup 2 inspections (100 percent inspections). The subgroup 2 inspections shall be in accordance with MIL–PRF–31032, and as specified in table I, subgroup 2.

4.4.2.1 PDA limits. The PDA limits for subgroup 2 inspections shall be 50 percent.

4.4.3 Subgroup 3 inspections (sample). Panels and printed boards to be delivered in accordance with this specification shall have been subjected to and passed all the inspections of table I, subgroups 3a, 3b, and 3c.

4.4.3.1 Sampling. Samples shall be randomly selected from each inspection lot. The lot conformance inspection sample plan uses a two-character designator that identifies the inspection specimen (first letter) and the C=0 sample size series (second letter) in accordance with appendix E of MIL–PRF–31032. The letter "B" is used as the first letter when pallets or production printed boards are to be sampled in their deliverable form. The letter "T" is used as the first letter when test vehicles (test coupons or partial or whole production panels) are to be sampled based on the number of panels in the lot. The second letter of the two-character designator uses the letters "H", "J", and "N" to identify the C=0 sample size series. The C=0 sample size series identifies the number to sample based on the lot size.

4.4.3.1.1 Panels and pallets. When a verification is performed when the printed boards are still on either a partial or whole production panel, the number to be sampled shall be the number of production panels in the lot, not the number of printed boards on the production panel. When the deliverable item is a pallet (or array) of printed boards, the number to be used for sampling is the number of pallets in the lot, not the number of printed boards on the pallet.

4.4.3.1.2 Hole Solderability test coupons. When using the "S" test coupon, the number of samples to be tested shall be based on a statistical sample of the inspection panels in the lot using plan TJ. When using the "A" test coupon, the number of samples to be tested shall be based on the same statistical sample as the "S" test coupon, but a multiple of 4 shall be applied to the resulting sample size. The "A" test coupons shall be selected in groups of 4, taken from the same inspection panel.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. Lot conformance inspection.

Inspection	Requirement paragraph	Method paragraph	Specimen to test 1/				Sample plan 2/
			B/P	THM	SMT	MIX	
Subgroup 1 (Panel acceptance)							
Solder float thermal stress	3.7.6.2.1	4.7.6.2.1		A and B	A and B	A and B	See 4.4.1.1 and 4.4.1.2
Subgroup 2 (100 percent)							
Continuity	3.7.5.1	4.7.5.1	X				100 percent 3/
Isolation (circuit shorts)	3.7.5.2	4.7.5.2	X				100 percent 3/
Subgroup 3a (Sample)							
External visual and dimensional acceptability 5/ 6/	3.7.1	4.7.1	X				Plan BF or TJ 4/
Subgroup 3b (Sample)							
Chemical:							
Ionic contamination 7/	3.7.3.1.1	4.7.3.1	X				Plan BN or TN 8/
Subgroup 3c (Sample)							
Physical:							
Adhesion, marking	3.7.4.1	4.7.4.1	X	9/	9/	9/	Plan BF or TJ 8/
Adhesion, plating 10/	3.7.4.2	4.7.4.2	X	C	C	C	Plan BF or TJ 8/
Adhesion, solder mask	3.7.4.3	4.7.4.3	X	G	G 11/	G 11/	Plan BF or TJ 8/
Bow and twist	3.7.4.4	4.7.4.4	X				Plan BH
Solderability							
Hole	3.7.4.8.1			S or A		A or S	See 12/
Surface	3.7.4.8.2	4.7.4.8			C or M	C or M	Plan TJ

1/ Unless otherwise specified, test coupons are in accordance with IPC–2221. B/P is either a production printed board separated from the panel, a pallet of boards, or a partial or whole production panel of printed boards; THM is a through-hole mount test coupon; SMT is a surface mount test coupon; MIX is for printed board designs containing both through-hole and surface mount components test coupon.
2/ See MIL–PRF–31032 for C=0 sampling plans. See 4.4.3.1 for explanation of codes.
3/ At the acquiring activity's option for designs that will have only connectors joined to the completed assembly, electrical testing can be performed at the assembly level (see 6.2.2.g).
4/ See 4.4.3.1.1 for test specimen selection options.
5/ Design (3.3), conductor spacing (3.5.2.4.1), conductor width (3.5.2.4.2), conductor imperfections (3.5.2.3) and workmanship (3.9) shall be inspected on both the internal layers containing conductors prior to lamination and the completed printed board.
6/ Surface imperfections (3.5.1.1.2) and subsurface imperfections (3.5.1.2) shall be inspected prior to solder mask application.
7/ Inspection shall be performed prior to solder mask application. Additional inspections on completed printed boards may be specified.
8/ Test coupon, partial or whole production panel, pallet, or production printed board, manufacturer option.
9/ See 4.7.4.1 for test specimen description and quantity.
10/ Applicable to platings only. This inspection does not need to be performed on solder or organic coatings.
11/ Test coupon "T" shall be used when production printed boards have tented via holes.
12/ See 4.4.3.1.2 for test specimen options and quantity.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4.3.2 Alternative subgroup 3a sample inspection (first piece produced design inspection). In lieu of performing sample inspections of all characteristics or parameters detailed on the applicable printed board procurement documentation during subgroup 3a, the manufacturers may use first piece produced design inspection for product acceptance. This type of inspection is only applicable to the criteria described in 4.4.3.2.1 and 4.4.3.2.2. The first piece produced design inspection can be performed on the first printed wiring board that is representative of all printed wiring boards in the production lot of the design. The use of automated inspection technology shall be acceptable.

4.4.3.2.1 Board features and conductor pattern. Unless otherwise specified, the accuracy of the printed board features and conductor pattern may be verified by performing first piece produced design inspection on a representative first production run piece or by sampling the printed boards in the lot.

4.4.3.2.2 Hole pattern accuracy. Unless otherwise specified, only the holes that are specifically dimensioned on the applicable printed board procurement documentation shall be inspected for hole pattern accuracy to meet the board dimensional requirements specified. The accuracy of the hole pattern may be verified by performing first piece produced design inspection on a representative first production run piece. Unless otherwise specified, the hole pattern accuracy of nonspecifically dimensioned holes, such as plated through holes and vias, do not need to be checked as their locations are controlled by external and internal annular ring requirements.

4.4.3.3 PDA limits. When 100 percent of a production lot is inspected, either in lieu of sampling or due to rejection of a sample inspection lot, the PDA limits for this 100 percent inspection shall be 50 percent.

4.5 Periodic conformance inspection. Periodic conformance inspection shall be in accordance with TRB approved periodic conformance inspection plan or table II herein.

TABLE II. Periodic conformance inspection baseline test coverage.

Inspection	Requirement paragraph	Method paragraph	Frequency
Elongation 1/	3.7.3.2.1	4.7.3.2	Monthly
Tensile strength 1/	3.7.3.2.2	4.7.3.3	Monthly
Purity of copper	3.7.3.2.3	4.7.3.4	Monthly
Flexibility endurance 2/	3.7.4.5	4.7.4.5	Annually
Folding flexibility 2/	3.7.4.6	4.7.4.6	Annually
Surface peel strength 3/	3.7.4.9	4.7.4.9	Monthly
Rework simulation 2/	3.7.4.7	4.7.4.7	Monthly
Moisture and insulation resistance 2/	3.7.6.1	4.7.6.1	Monthly

1/ A minimum of ten test specimens (five lengthwise and five crosswise) shall be inspected.
2/ A minimum of two test specimens shall be inspected.
3/ A minimum of eight test specimens (four each from two lots) shall be inspected.

4.6 Capability verification inspection. Capability verification inspection shall be in accordance with the TRB approved capability verification inspection plan. The frequency of this verification shall be as a minimum every 2 years. Each base material type qualified shall be verified. The following tests and inspections should be considered when accomplishing capability verification inspection: Thermal shock (see 3.7.6.3), convection air oven solder reflow thermal stress (see 3.7.6.2.2) and direct current induced thermal cycling (see 3.7.6.4.1).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.7 Methods of inspection.

4.7.1 Acceptability verification.

4.7.1.1 Visual inspection. The visual features of the printed board specimen shall be inspected in accordance with test method number 2.1.8 of IPC–TM–650, except that the magnification shall be 1.75x (3 diopters), minimum. If confirmation of a suspect defect cannot be determined at 1.75x, it shall be verified at progressively higher magnifications, up to 30x.

4.7.1.2 Dimensional inspection. The dimensional features of the printed board test specimen shall be inspected using test method numbers 2.2.1 and 2.2.2 of IPC–TM–650, as applicable. Referee inspection needed to confirm a suspected defect of the printed board test specimen features shall be accomplished at a magnification of up to 30X, as applicable to confirm the suspected defect.

4.7.1.3 Alternate plating and coating measurement techniques. When a conductor surface finish plating or coating thickness is below 0.00125 mm (.00005 inch), the thickness measurements shall be performed in accordance with one of the following procedures:

a. ASTM B567, measurement of thickness by the beta backscatter method.

b. ASTM B568, measurement of thickness by X-ray spectrometry.

4.7.2 DPA by microsection evaluation. Microsection examination (to evaluate characteristics such as plated-through holes, plating thickness, or foil thickness) shall be accomplished by using the following preparation and inspection methods.

4.7.2.1 Microsection preparation. Microsection preparation shall be accomplished by using methods in accordance with either method A or B of test method number 2.1.1 of IPC–TM–650. Automatic microsectioning techniques may be used in lieu of IPC–TM–650 methods. The following details shall apply:

a. Number of holes for each test specimen. A minimum of at least three plated holes shall be cross sectioned vertically for each test specimen required.

b. Grinding and polishing accuracy.

(1) Through holes and non-copper filled microvias. The grinding and polishing accuracy for mounts shall be in accordance with the minimum qualities specified in test method 2.1.1 of IPC–TM–650.

(2) Copper filled microvias. The grinding and polishing accuracy shall be sufficient to evaluate the plating to microvia target land contact dimension.

c. Pre–microetch evaluations. The plated holes shall be evaluated for plating separations prior to microetching.

d. When more than two test specimens are contained in a mount (coupon–stacking or gang mounting), the following shall apply:

(1) The test specimens shall not be in direct contact with any other specimen in the mount. The recommended minimum distance between test specimens in a mount is 0.25 mm (.010 inch).

(2) The traceability requirements of MIL–PRF–31032 shall apply.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.7.2.2 Microsection examination and inspection. Microsection examination and inspection shall be accomplished in accordance with test method number 2.2.5 of IPC–TM–650 to evaluate characteristics such as dielectric spacing, etchback, plating thickness, foil thickness, and so forth, in plated holes. If more than three plated holes are in a row on a test specimen, as with the A/B coupon design, all holes in the row shall be evaluated. Each side of the three plated holes shall be viewed independently. The following details shall apply:

a. Magnifications. The test specimens shall be inspected at magnifications specified in test method number 2.2.5 of IPC–TM–650. Referee inspections shall be accomplished at a magnification of 200x to 400x for through holes and 400 to 500X for microvias.

b. Pre and post microetch evaluations. The plated holes shall be evaluated for plating separations both prior to and after microetching. Pre– and post–microetching evaluations shall be accomplished at magnifications specified above.

c. Measurements. Thickness measurements shall be averaged from at least three determinations for each side of the plated hole. Isolated thick or thin sections shall not be used for averaging; however, isolated areas of reduced copper thickness shall be measured and evaluated to the copper plating void rejection criteria specified in 3.6.4.3.1.

   EXAMPLE: The copper plating thickness of the plated–through hole wall shall be determined from the average of three measurements, approximately equally spaced, taken on each side of the hole.

d. Plating and coating thicknesses below 0.00125 mm (.00005 inch) shall not be measured using metallographic techniques. See 4.7.1.3 for alternate measurement techniques.

4.7.3 Chemical test methods.

4.7.3.1 Ionic contamination. The printed board specimen shall be inspected for ionic contamination in accordance with test method number 2.3.25 of IPC–TM–650.

4.7.3.2 Elongation of copper. The test for elongation of copper shall be performed in accordance with test method number 2.4.18.1 of IPC–TM–650. The travel speed of testing shall be 50.0 mm ±1.0 mm (1.97 ±.03 inches) for each minute.

4.7.3.3 Tensile strength of copper. The test for tensile strength of copper shall be performed in accordance with test method number 2.4.18.1 of IPC–TM–650 with the following exceptions:

a. The travel speed of testing shall be 50.0 mm ±1.0 mm (1.97 ±.03 inches) for each minute.

b. The mean average cross-sectional area shall be calculated using the following steps:

   1. Measure the thickness of specimens by use of an optimeter (an electrical-type measuring device) or vernier micrometer, provided that the thickness is measured to at least the nearest 2 percent.

   2. Measure and record the specimen width dimension to the nearest 0.025 mm (.001 inch).

   3. The mean average cross-sectional area is the result of the average thickness multiplied by the average width.

4.7.3.4 Purity of copper. The test for purity of plated copper shall be performed in accordance with test method number 2.3.15 of IPC-TM-650.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.7.4 Physical test methods.

4.7.4.1 Adhesion, marking. Test specimens which represent all types of marking used on the lot (except etched marking) shall be subjected to the solderability test in 4.7.4.8. The side of the test specimen that is marked shall be placed against the solder. After the test, the test specimen shall be examined in accordance with 4.7.1 and the requirements of 3.7.4.1 shall be met.

4.7.4.2 Adhesion, plating. The test for plating adhesion shall be performed in accordance with test method number 2.4.1 of IPC–TM–650.

4.7.4.3 Adhesion, solder mask. The test for solder mask adhesion shall be performed in accordance with test method number 2.4.28.1 of IPC–TM–650.

4.7.4.4 Bow and twist. The tests for bow and twist shall be performed in accordance with test method number 2.4.22 of IPC–TM–650.

4.7.4.5 Flexibility endurance.

4.7.4.5.1 Qualification and periodic tests. The flexibility endurance test shall be in accordance with test method number 2.4.3 of IPC–TM–650. The flexibility endurance test may also be performed using an alternative method specified in 6.6.2. The following exceptions shall apply:

a. Test specimen: Test specimens shall be production designs or test coupon in accordance with test method number 2.4.3 of IPC–TM–650.

b. Number of flex cycles: 100,000.

c. Diameter of mandrel. The diameter of the mandrel shall be 24 times the sum of the total ply thickness reduced to the nearest 3.0 mm (.12 inch).

d. Flexing rate: 0.3 seconds for each cycle, minimum.

e. Travel of loop (when applicable): 30.0 mm (1.18 inch) minimum.

4.7.4.5.2 Acquiring activity specified. The flexibility endurance test shall be in accordance with test method number 2.4.3 of IPC–TM–650. The following details shall be specified (see 6.2.2.c):

a. Number of flex cycles.

b. Diameter of mandrel.

c. Flexing rate.

d. The length of travel of loop.

4.7.4.6 Folding flexibility.

4.7.4.6.1 Qualification and periodic tests. The folding flexibility test shall be performed in accordance with 4.7.4.6.3 and figure 17. The following details shall apply:

a. Points of application (detail C on figure 17): The mandrel shall be centered in the flexible area.

b. Diameter of mandrel (detail D on figure 17): The diameter of mandrel shall be 24 times overall material thickness, reduced to the nearest 3.0 mm (.12 inch).

c. Number of fold cycles: Twenty-five fold cycles as defined in 4.7.4.6.3 shall be preformed.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.7.4.6.2 Acquiring activity specified. The folding flexibility test shall be performed in accordance with 4.7.4.6.3 and figure 4. The following details shall be specified (see 6.2.2.d):

a. Direction of bend (detail A on figure 17).

b. Degree of bend (detail B on figure 17).

c. Points of application (detail C on figure 17).

d. Diameter of mandrel (detail D on figure 17): The diameter of mandrel shall be 24 times overall material thickness, reduced to the nearest 3.0 mm (.12 inch).

e. Number of fold cycles.

4.7.4.6.3 Fold cycle. A fold cycle shall be defined as taking one end of the specimen and folding it around a mandrel (detail D on figure 17) and then unfold back to the original starting position, traveling 180 degrees in one direction and 180 degrees in the opposite direction. A fold cycle may also be defined as folding (using opposite ends) the ends toward each other (fold the same direction) and then unfold back to the original starting position, with each end traveling 90 degrees in one direction and 90 degrees in the opposite direction. The specified number of fold cycles shall be performed with the mandrel placed in contact with the specimen on one side and then again with the mandrel placed in contact with the specimen on the opposite side.

4.7.4.7 Rework simulation. The rework simulation test shall be performed in accordance with test method number 2.4.36 of IPC–TM–650. The following details shall apply:

a. Unless otherwise specified, method A shall be used initially.

b. For designs with an overall printed board thickness greater than 3.0 mm (.118 inches), one row of plated-through holes shall be used to assure that the pre-designated method to be used for the soldering and desoldering operation will produce satisfactory solder connections (the wire is wetted through the entire plated-through hole within the soldering time limits specified in the test method) for the printed wiring board test specimen design being tested.

c. In case of an unsatisfactory solder connection (an insufficient solder connection is produced or the soldering time exceeds the limits specified in the test method), another plated-through hole on the row shall be soldered using the soldering temperature of the next higher method (e.g., method B if method A is insufficient, or method C if method B does not suffice) until a satisfactory solder connection is made. If the temperatures of method C still yields unsatisfactory solder connections, consult the qualifying activity for additional guidance before proceeding further with the testing.

d. Once a method that produces satisfactory solder connections has been determined, the soldering and desoldering operation shall proceed using a different row of plated-through holes which will be evaluated to the acceptance criteria of 3.7.4.7 herein. The final test method selected shall be noted in the test report.

4.7.4.8 Solderability. The tests for hole or surface solderability shall be performed in accordance with appendix J of MIL–PRF–31032.

4.7.4.9 Surface peel strength (foil laminated printed boards). The peel strength shall be tested and inspected in accordance with condition A of test method number 2.4.8 of IPC–TM–650. Conditions B and C (after thermal stress condition and after exposure to processing chemicals tests) shall not be performed. Plated tin-lead, solder coating, or other plated metallic resist shall be chemically removed prior to test or shall be prevented from being deposited during manufacturing. The test specimen shall not be coated with any organic coating prior to testing. All peel strength readings obtained shall meet the minimum requirement. No individual value in the calculation of the average peel strength shall be more than 0.26 N/mm (1.5 pounds for each inch) less than the specified minimum value.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.7.5 Electrical test methods.

4.7.5.1 Continuity and isolation, production screening. Printed boards shall be electrical tested using either automatic or manual equipment capable of verifying the level C requirements of IPC–9252 for 100 percent continuity and isolation.

4.7.5.2 Continuity and isolation, qualification and periodic testing.

4.7.5.2.1 Continuity. A current shall be passed through each conductor or group of interconnected conductors by applying electrodes on the terminals at each end of the conductor or group of conductors. The current passed through the conductors shall not exceed those specified in the applicable design standard for the smallest conductor in the circuit.

4.7.5.2.2 Isolation (circuit shorts). A test voltage shall be applied between all common portions of each conductor pattern and all adjacent common portions of each conductor pattern. The test voltage shall be applied between conductor patterns of each layer and the electrically isolated pattern of each adjacent layer. For manual testing, the test voltage shall be 200 volts minimum and shall be applied for a minimum of 5 seconds. When automated test equipment is used, the minimum applied test voltage shall be the maximum rated voltage specified. If the maximum rated voltage on the printed board is not specified, the test voltage shall be 40 volts minimum.

4.7.6 Environmental test methods.

4.7.6.1 Moisture and insulation resistance. The test for moisture and insulation resistance shall be performed in accordance with class 3 test conditions of test method number 2.6.3 of IPC–TM–650 using specimen preparation method A. The initial and final insulation resistance shall be greater than, or equal to, 500M ohm when measured at 500 volts (+10, –0 percent) dc.

4.7.6.2 Resistance to soldering heat.

4.7.6.2.1 Solder float thermal stress. The test for solder float thermal stress shall be performed in accordance with appendix F of MIL–PRF–31032. The following details shall apply. Printed wiring board test specimens constructed of adhesiveless metal-clad flexible base materials shall be subjected to condition A. Printed wiring board test specimens constructed of adhesive flexible metal-clad base materials shall be subjected to condition B. Printed wiring board test specimens constructed of both adhesive and adhesiveless metal-clad flexible base materials shall be subjected to condition B.

4.7.6.2.2 Solder reflow thermal stress. The test for solder reflow thermal stress shall be performed in accordance with condition D of appendix F of MIL–PRF–31032.

4.7.6.3 Thermal shock. The test for thermal shock shall be performed in accordance with test method number 2.6.7.2 of IPC–TM–650 except that the temperature extremes shall be –65 degree Celsius and +125 degrees Celsius for all coverlayer, flexible, and rigid base material combinations and the minimum dwell time at each temperature extreme shall be 15 minutes.

4.7.6.4 Temperature cycling.

4.7.6.4.1 DC current induced. The test for DC current induced thermal cycling shall be performed in accordance with test method number 2.6.26 of IPC–TM–650.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging requirement. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). When packaging of materiel is to be performed by DoD or in-house contractor personnel, these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are maintained by the Inventory Control Point's packaging activities within the Military Service or Defense Agency, or within the Military Service's system commands. Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing Military Department's or Defense Agency's automated packaging files, CD–ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Notes. The notes specified in MIL–PRF–31032 are applicable to this specification.

6.1.1 Intended use. This specification sheet was developed for the use of verifying performance characteristics of multilayer (three or more conductor layers) flexible and rigid-flex printed wiring boards with or without plated holes, that will use soldering for component/part mounting. Other flex or rigid-flex printed board technology types (such as single or double sided designs) can be verified to the requirements contained in this document, however, the performance parameters and baseline verification methods of other MIL–PRF–31032 performance specifications sheets may be more appropriate.

6.2 Acquisition requirements.

6.2.1 Primary acquisition data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, revision letter, and date of this specification.

b. The specific issue of individual documents referenced (see section 2).

c. Title, number, and date of applicable printed board procurement documentation or drawing. Identification of the originating design activity and, if applicable, the Government approved deviation list for the printed board procurement documentation or drawing.

d. The complete product procurement documentation part or identifying number (see 3.1).

e. The printed wiring board type (type 3 or 4, see 1.2.1 and 3.1) and installation use classification (use A or B, see 1.2.2 and 3.1).

f. Title, number, revision letter (with amendment number when applicable), and date of the applicable design standard with performance classification.

g. Requirements for delivery of one copy of the quality conformance inspection data or records pertinent to the product inspection lot to be supplied with each shipment by the QML manufacturer, if applicable.

h. Requirements for certificate of compliance, if applicable.

i. Requirements for notification of change of product or process to the contracting activity in addition to notification to the qualifying activity, if applicable.

j. Packaging required (see 5.1).

k. If special or additional identification marking is required (see 3.8).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.2.2 Optional acquisition data. The following items are optional and are only applicable when specified in the printed board procurement documentation.

a. If any special or additional cleanliness is required (see 3.7.3.1).

b. Special requirements for bow and twist (see 3.7.4.4).

c. Special requirements for flex endurance (see 3.7.4.5).

d. Special requirements for folding flexibility (see 3.7.4.6).

e. The solderability test method to be used (see 3.7.4.8 and appendix J of MIL–PRF–31032).

f. If any accelerated aging for solderability testing is required (see appendix J of MIL–PRF–31032).

g. Special requirements for electrical testing at the assembly level (see table I, footnote 3).

h. Requirements for failure analysis, corrective action and reporting of results.

i. Disposition of lot conformance inspection sample units.

j. Surface (foil lamination) peel strength, if applicable (see 3.7.4.9).

k. Any other additional special requirements.

6.3 Qualification. With respect to products requiring qualification, awards will be made only for products which are, at the time of award of contract, qualified for inclusion in Qualified Manufacturers List (QML–31032) whether or not such products have actually been so listed by that date. The attention of the contractors is called to these requirements, and manufacturers are urged to arrange to have the products that they propose to offer to the Federal Government tested for qualification in order that they may be eligible to be awarded contracts or orders for the products covered by this specification. Information pertaining to qualification of products may be obtained from DLA Land and Maritime, ATTN: VQE, P.O. Box 3990, Columbus, OH 43218–3990 or e-mail 5998.Qualifications@dla.mil or at URL https://landandmaritimeapps.dla.mil/Offices/Sourcing_and_Qualification/offices.aspx. An online listing of products qualified to this specification may be found in the Qualified Products Database (QPD) at http://qpldocs.dla.mil.

6.4 Replacement information. This specification includes a majority of the performance requirements of previous revisions of MIL–P–50884 for types 3 and 4 printed wiring boards. Printed wiring boards conforming to this specification sheet would be comparable to printed wiring boards conforming to MIL–P–50884.

6.5 Plated-through holes and vias (see 3.6).

6.5.1 Plated-through holes. Throughout this document the terms "plated-through hole" and "plated-through holes" is used to describe plated-through holes and all forms of blind vias, buried vias, and through vias.

6.5.2 Blind, buried, and through vias. This specification includes provisions for verifying the performance of type 4 rigid printed wiring boards containing blind vias, buried vias, controlled depth drilled vias, laser drilled vias, low aspect ratio blind vias, microvias, semi-blind vias, semi-buried vias, through vias, and trepanned vias.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.6 Notes regarding optional verification testing.

6.6.1 Cleanliness. This optional verification test is not listed in table I, lot conformance inspection. If verification is required, the acquiring activity should specify acceptability requirements and test specimen sampling frequency.

6.6.2 Flexibility endurance. The flexibility endurance test may be performed using test method number 2.4.3.1 of IPC–TM–650.

6.7 Stiffener adhesion test and requirement. This document does not include the stiffener adhesion test or requirement contained in MIL–P–50884. All stiffeners are viewed as a mechanical support and total bonding of the stiffener to the printed wiring board is not required for compliance with this document.

6.8 Tin finishes and whisker growth. Use of tin plating or coating is prohibited (see 3.4.1). The use of alloys with tin content greater than 97 percent, by mass, may exhibit tin whisker growth problems after manufacture. Tin whiskers may occur anytime from a day to years after manufacture and can develop under typical operating conditions on products that use such materials. Conformal coatings applied over top of a whisker-prone surface will not prevent the formation of tin whiskers. Alloys containing at least 3 percent lead, by mass, have shown to inhibit the growth of tin whiskers. For additional information on this matter, refer to ASTM B545 (Standard Specification for Electrodeposited Coating of Tin).

6.9 Amendment notations. The margins of this specification are marked with vertical lines to indicate modifications generated by this amendment. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

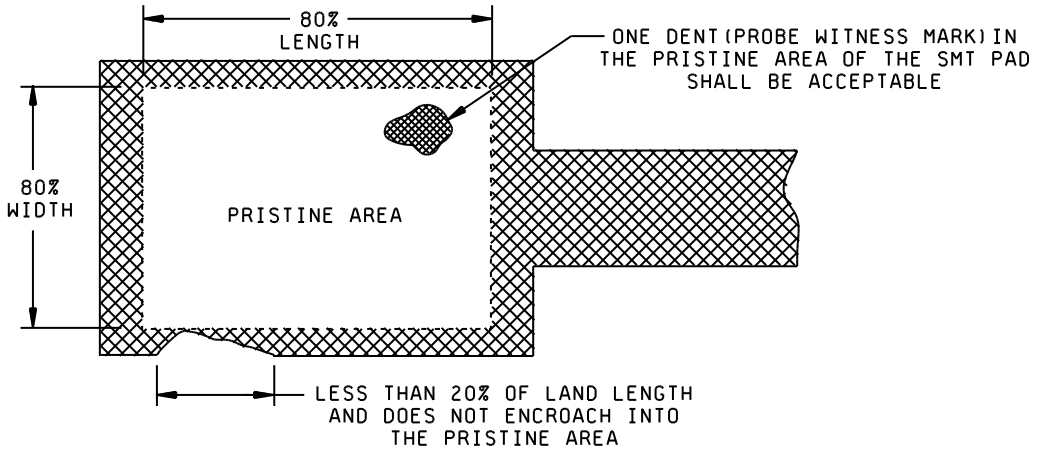


FIGURE 1. Rectangular surface mount lands.

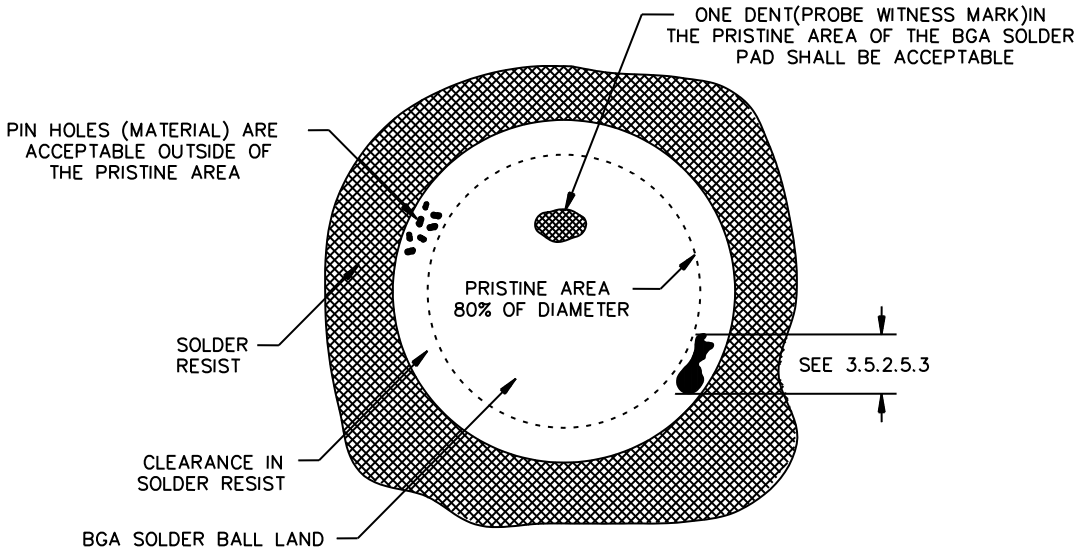


FIGURE 2. Round surface mount lands (BGA pads).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

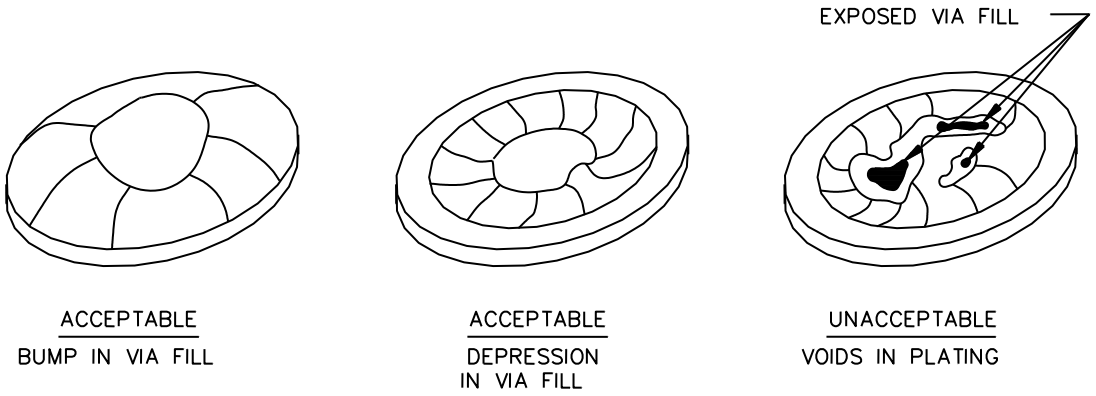


FIGURE 3. Via copper cap plating deviations.

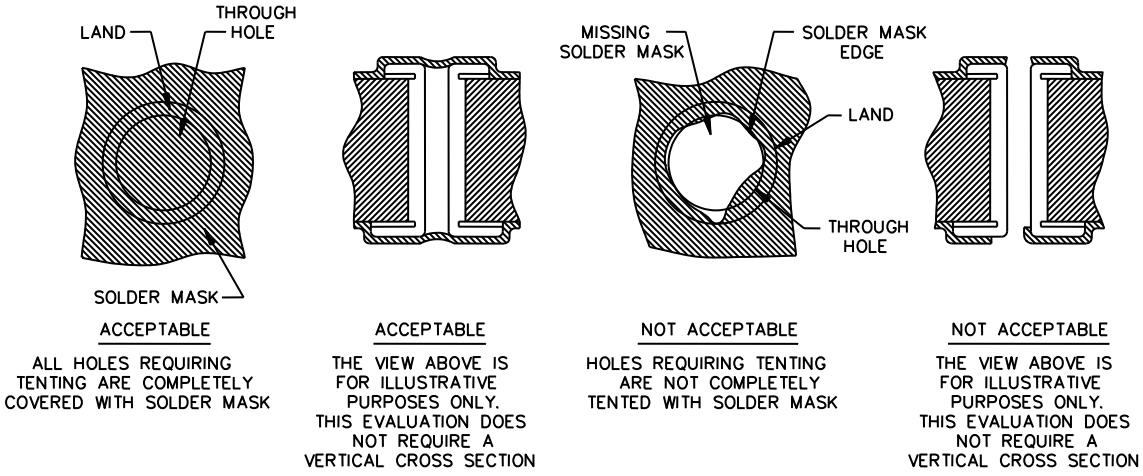
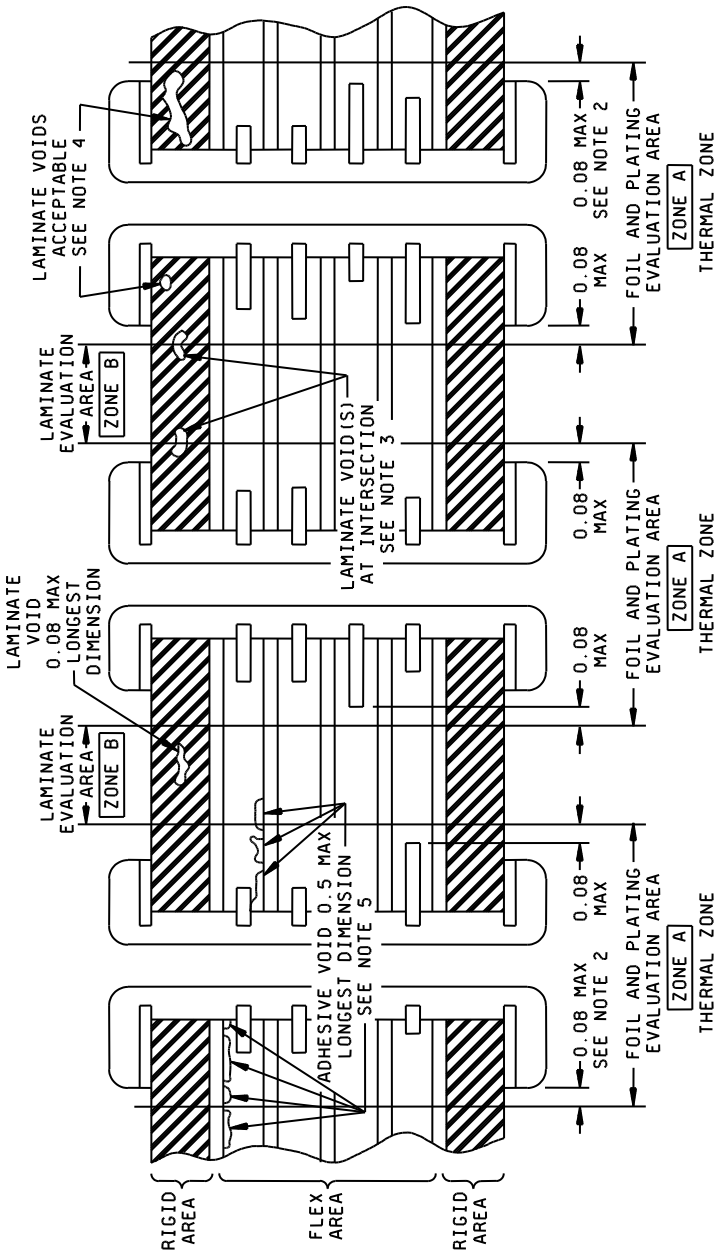


FIGURE 4. Solder mask tenting deviations.

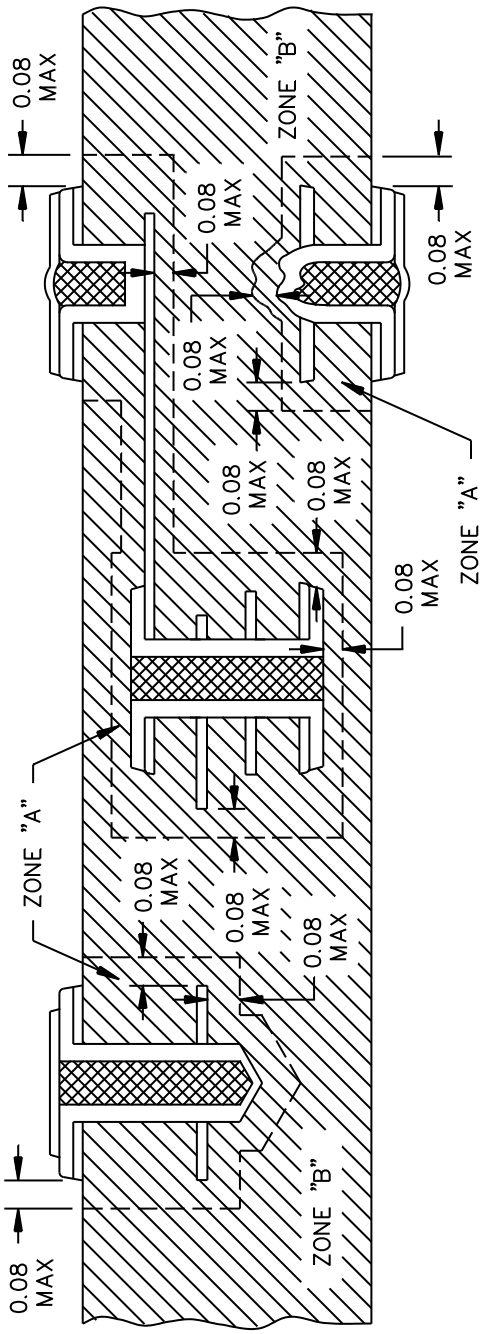
Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



NOTES:
1. Dimensions are in millimeters.
2. Typically beyond land edge most radially extended.
3. Voids at intersection of zone A and zone B. Laminate voids greater than 0.08 (.0031 inch) that extend into zone B are rejectable.
4. Laminate voids are not evaluated in zone A.
5. Multiple adhesive voids between two adjacent plated-through holes in the same plane shall not have a combined length exceeding 0.5 mm (.02 inch).

FIGURE 5. Typical plated-through hole cross section after resistance to soldering heat or rework simulation.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



NOTES:
1. Dimensions are in millimeters.
2. The thermal zone (zone A) is defined by a 0.08 mm (.003 inch) perimeter that extends entirely from each via structure. Parts of the structure include internal and external lands.
3. The laminate evaluation area (zone B) is the remaining part of the crossection outside zone A. Voids at intersection of zone A and zone B. Laminate voids greater than 0.08 mm (.003 inch) that extend into zone B are rejectable.
4. Laminate voids are not evaluated in zone A.

FIGURE 6. Thermal zone for blind and buried via cross section after stress testing.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

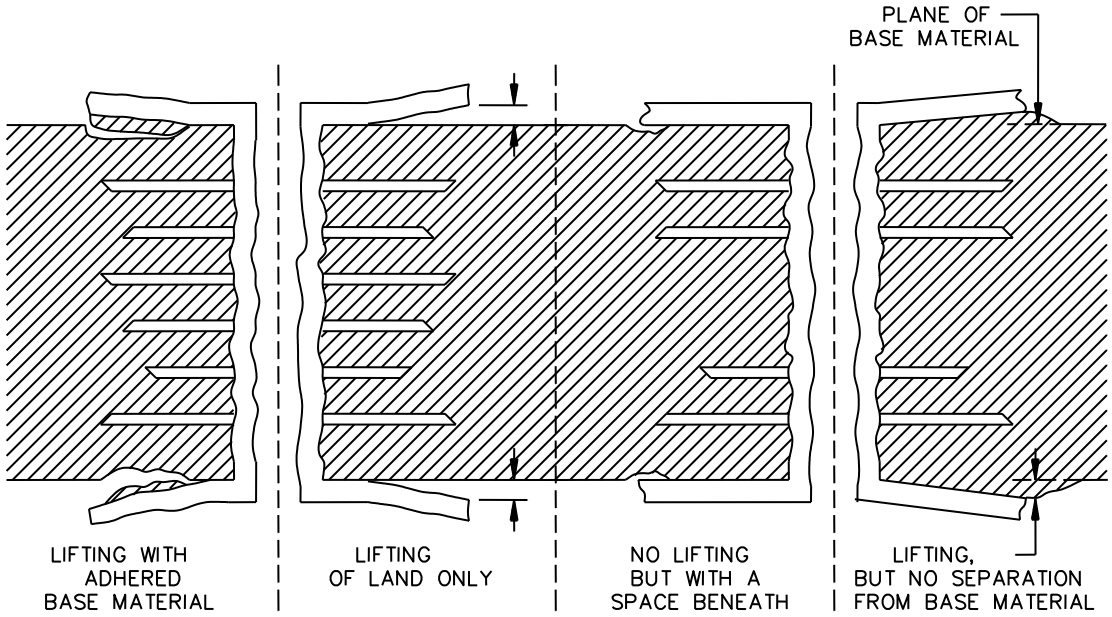


FIGURE 7. Types of lifted lands.

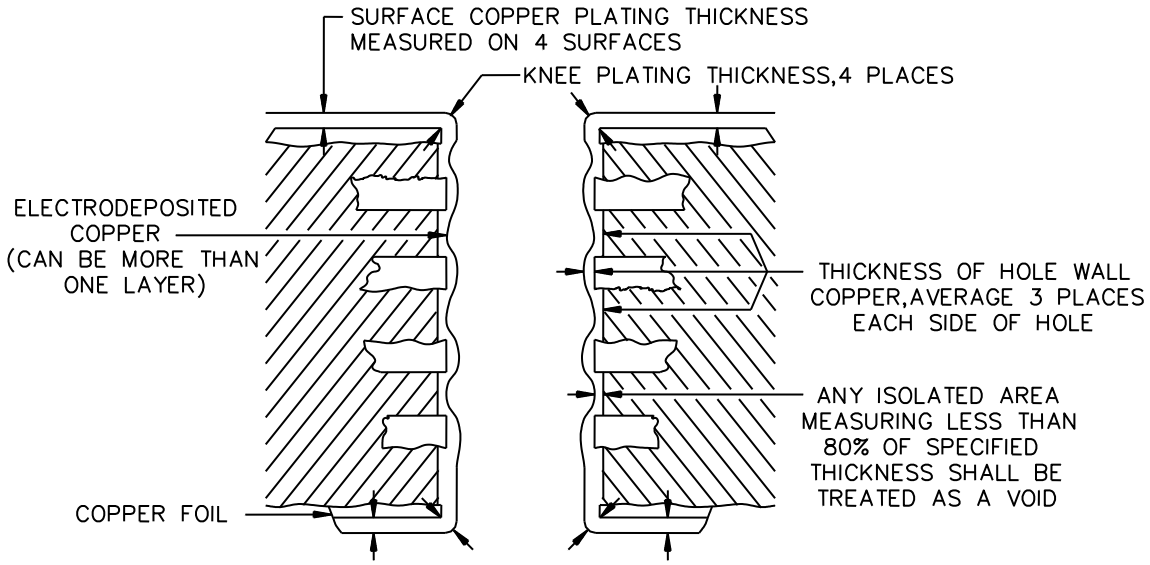


FIGURE 8. Copper plating thickness.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

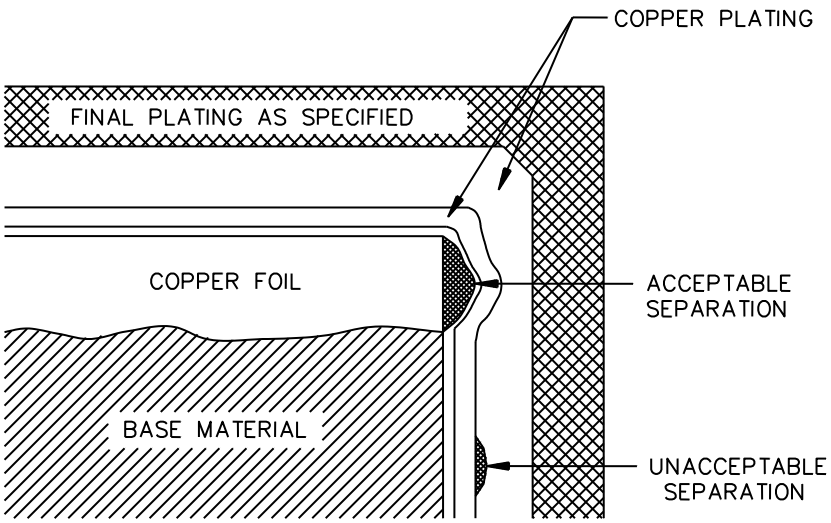


FIGURE 9. Conductive interface separations.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

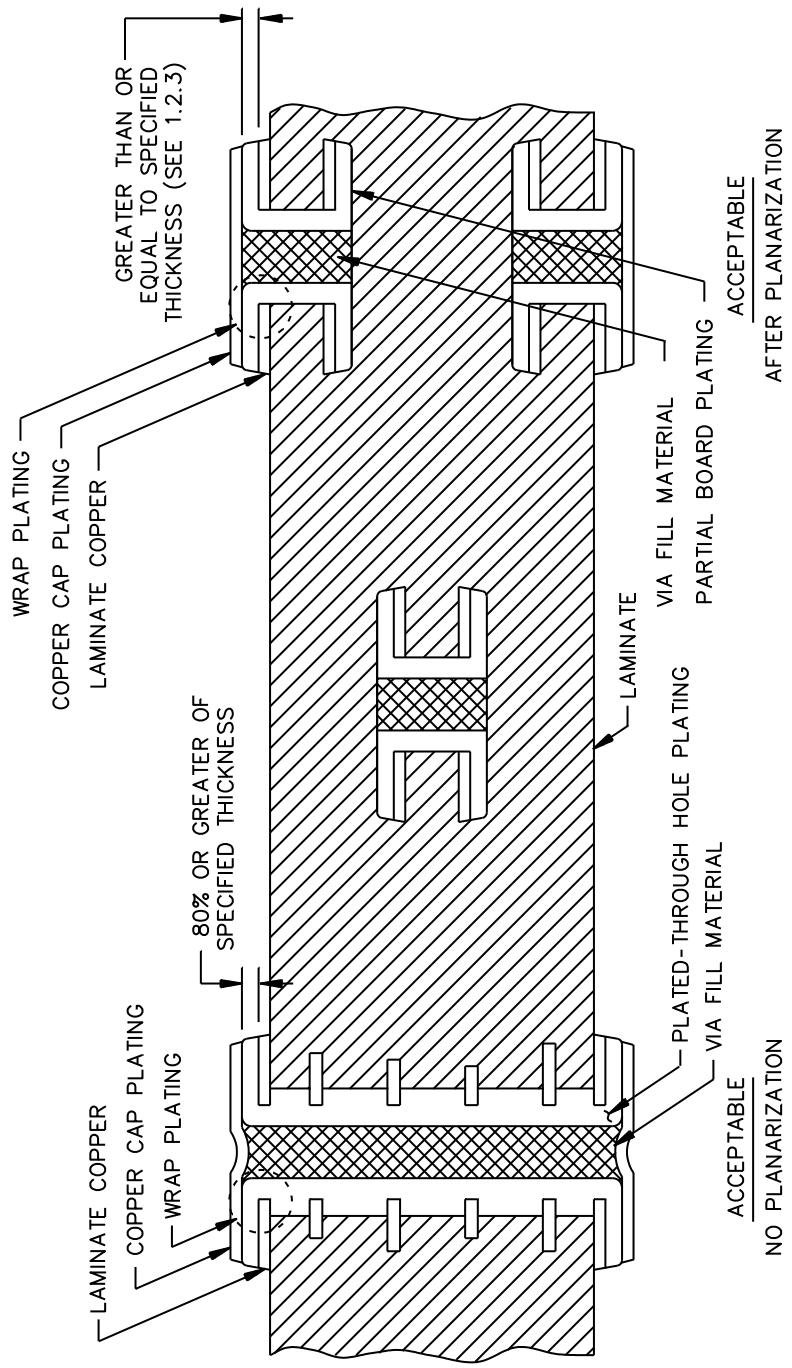


FIGURE 10. Acceptable plated-through hole wrap plating (continuous hole-knee-surface copper plating).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

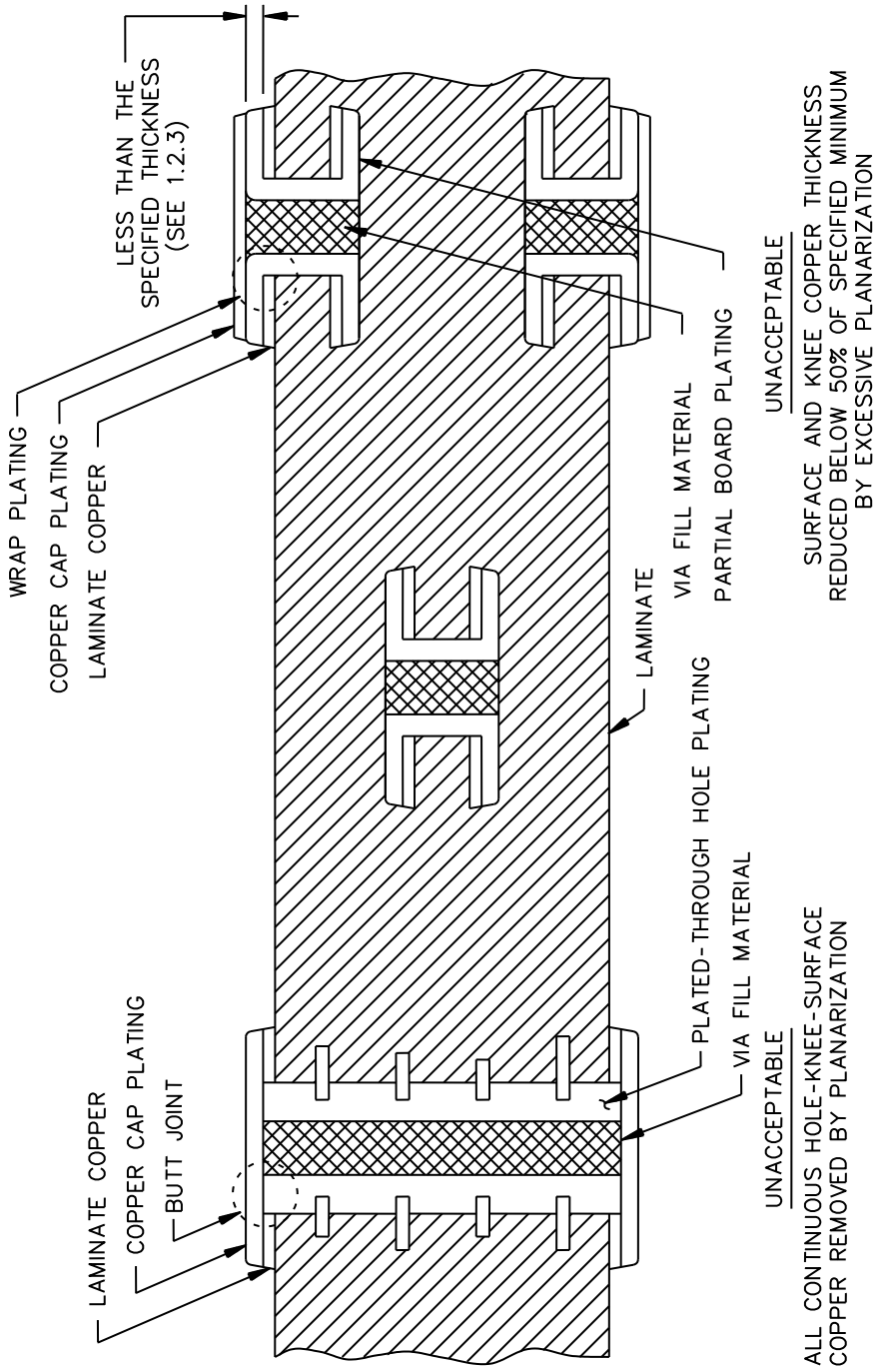


FIGURE 11. Unacceptable plated-through hole wrap plating (continuous hole-knee-surface copper plating).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

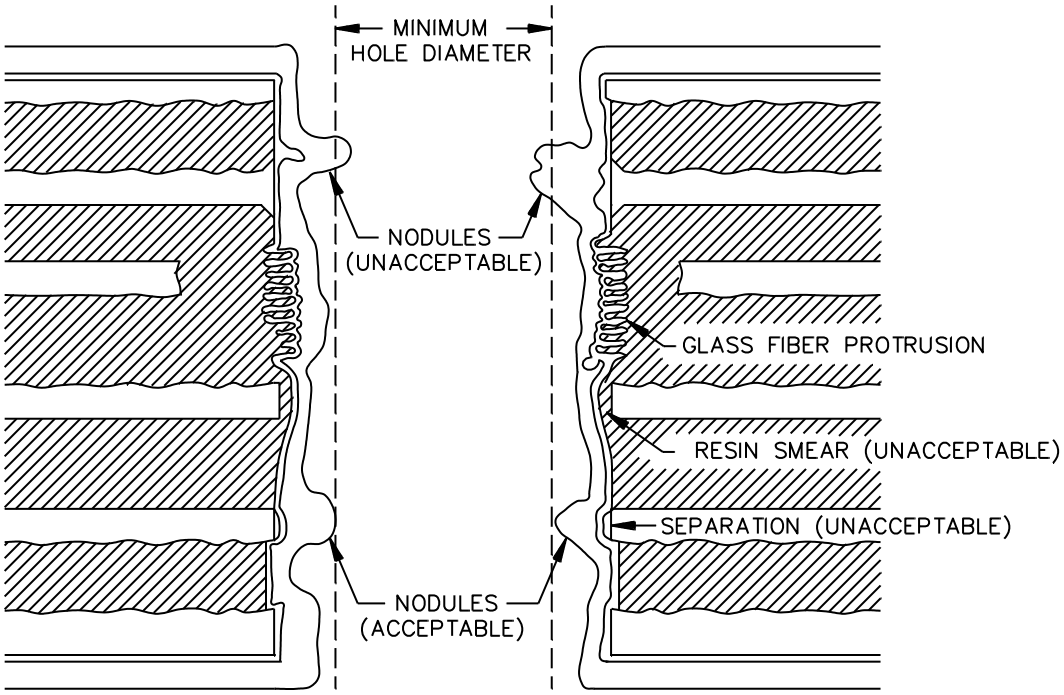
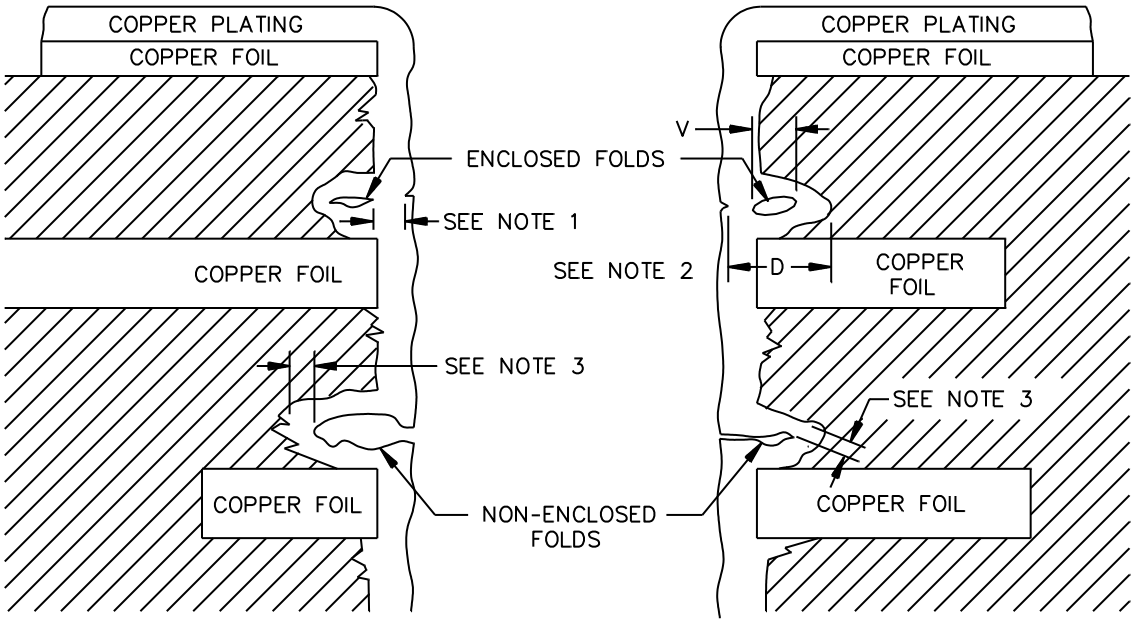


FIGURE 12. Plated through hole deficiencies.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



NOTES:

1. Minimum copper plating thickness measurement point. Plating folds that are enclosed shall be acceptable if the minimum copper plating thickness is met.
2. Measure the distances between lines on inclusion and the overall . The dimension D minus dimension V must meet the minimum copper plating thickness. Regions with the appearance of plating folds where there is no plating demarcation evident between the void and the inside edge of plating.
3. Minimum copper plating thickness measurement point. Plating folds that are not enclosed shall be acceptable if the minimum copper plating thickness is met.

FIGURE 13. Plating fold evaluation.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

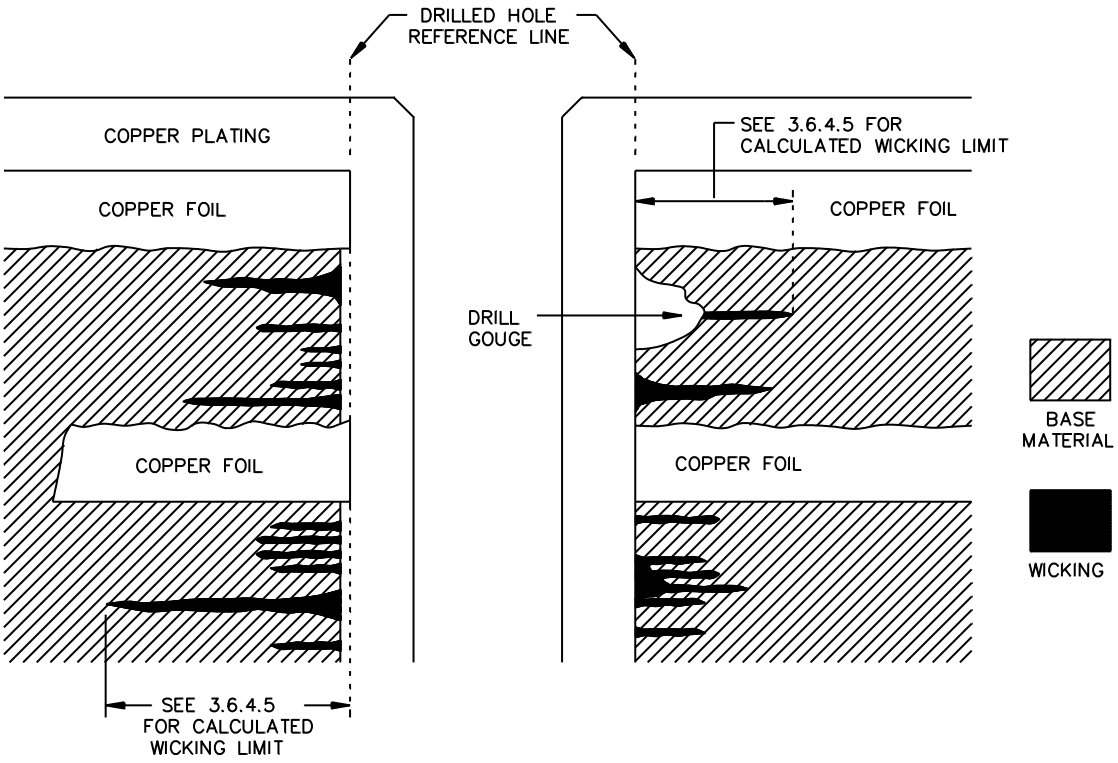


FIGURE 14. Wicking.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

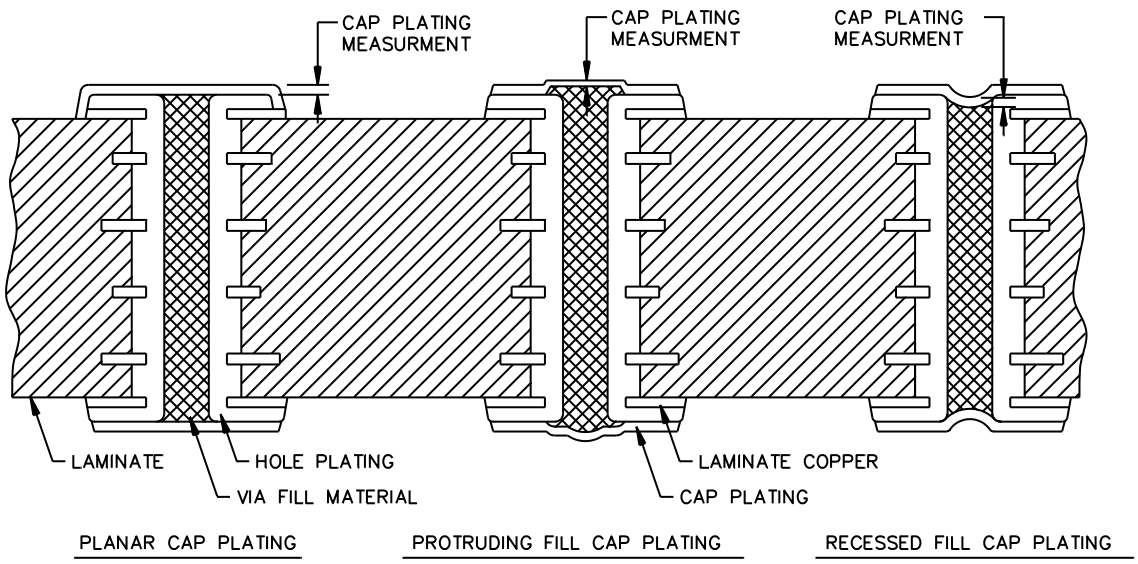


FIGURE 15. Acceptable via cap plating.

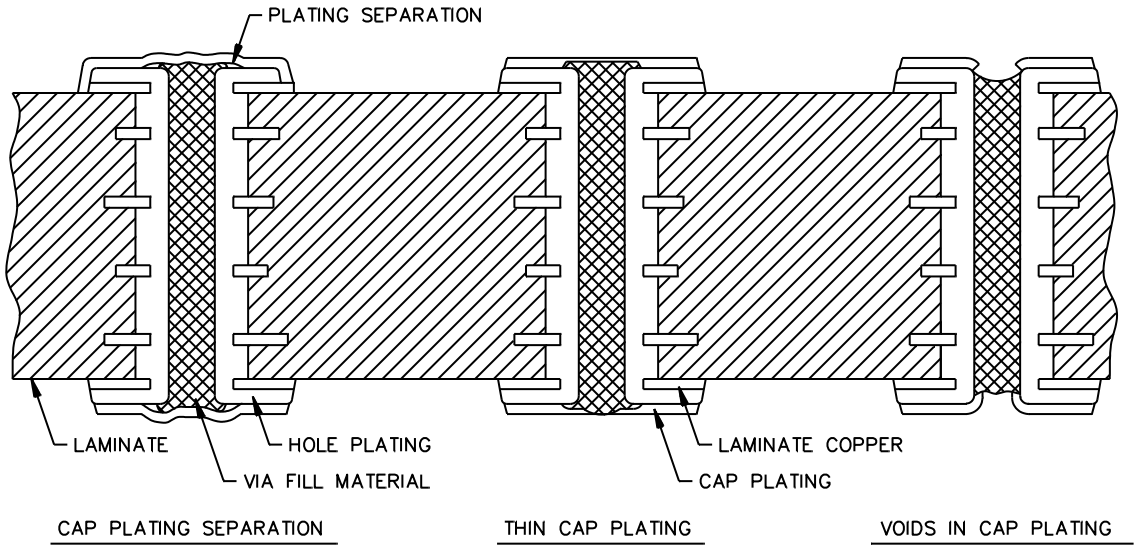


FIGURE 16. Unacceptable via cap plating.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

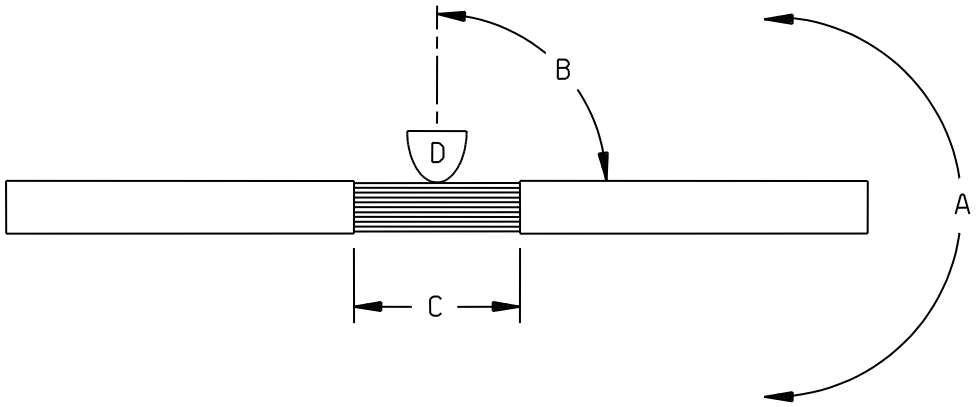


FIGURE 17. Folding flexibility test.

Custodians:
Army – CR
Navy – EC
Air Force – 85
DLA – CC

Review activities:
Army – MI
Navy – CG
Air Force – 99

Preparing activity:
DLA – CC

(Project 5998–2018–018)

NOTE: The activities listed above were interested in this document as of the date of this document. Since organizations and responsibilities can change, you should verify the currency of the information above using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T03:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.